

BUS BOOST: 200 E-BUSES,
56 SPL BUSES FOR WOMEN **P3**



MEA: CREDIBILITY OF INDIA'S POLL
SYSTEM GLOBALLY RECOGNISED **P5**

'KALKI KOECHLIN ISN'T
THE VILLAIN OF ZNMD' **P14**



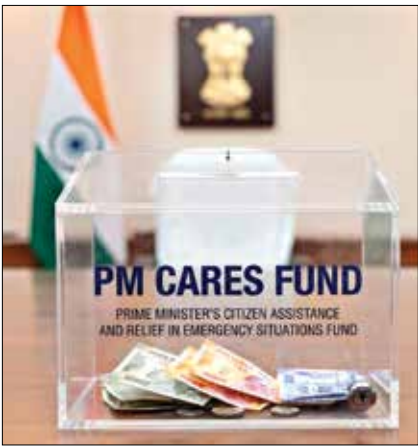
PM CARES Fund data released; corpus rises to Rs 8,452 crore

Domestic donations down by 30% to Rs 479 crore in FY25

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

The PM CARES Fund, set up by the Centre in March 2020 as a public charitable trust to respond to emergencies and distress situations, had a corpus of Rs 8,452.06 crore at the end of March 2025, according to its latest audited accounts. While questions over the fund's transparency, including its disclosure of expenditure and the absence of CAG and RTI scrutiny, have been raised since its inception, the Centre has maintained that PM CARES is funded entirely through voluntary contributions, receives no budgetary support and is not a "public authority" under the RTI Act. The latest statement shows that Rs 7,846.65 crore of the corpus was held in fixed deposits, while the fund spent Rs 87.85 lakh during 2024-25 and received Rs 479.04 crore in domestic donations and Rs 92.83 lakh in foreign contributions.

The fund entered 2024-25 with Rs 7,173 crore, of which



Rs 6,641.56 crore was held in fixed deposits and Rs 531.46 crore in savings bank accounts. By March 31, 2025, its total balance had risen by about Rs 1,279 crore, with fixed deposits increasing by about Rs 1,205 crore to Rs 7,846.65 crore. The remaining Rs 605.41 crore was held in savings bank accounts.

The latest accounts show a sharp fall in expenditure compared with the previous year. Total payments during 2024-25 stood at Rs 87.85 lakh, against

Rs 15.6 crore in 2023-24. Almost the entire amount, Rs 87.84 lakh, was spent under the PM CARES for Children Scheme, while Rs 451 went towards bank and SMS charges.

The fund received Rs 479.04 crore in domestic donations during the year, down around 30 per cent from Rs 681.8 crore in 2023-24. Foreign contributions also fell by about 18 per cent, from Rs 1.13 crore to Rs 92.83 lakh. The decline is more pronounced

when compared with the early years of the fund. Domestic contributions peaked at Rs 7,184 crore in 2020-21, before falling to Rs 1,896 crore in 2021-22 and Rs 909 crore in 2022-23. Foreign contributions stood at Rs 495 crore in 2020-21, before dropping to Rs 40 crore and Rs 2.57 crore in the following two years. The Rs 92.83 lakh received in 2024-25 was the second-lowest annual foreign contribution, after Rs 39.7 lakh in 2019-20.

KEY POINTS

- » Nearly Rs 7,847 crore, or 93%, was kept in fixed deposits
- » Rs 605.41 crore remained in savings bank accounts at year-end
- » Domestic donations fell 30% to Rs 479.04 crore during 2024-25
- » Foreign contributions declined 18% to Rs 92.83 lakh during 2024-25
- » Fixed deposits generated Rs 469.37 crore in interest during 2024-25
- » Savings accounts earned another Rs 5.77 crore in interest
- » Total interest income stood at Rs 475.14 crore during 2024-25
- » Implementing agencies returned Rs 324.66 crore to the fund
- » The refund was nearly four times the previous year's Rs 84.31 crore
- » The statement does not identify agencies behind the Rs 324.66-crore refund

Top Court panel of judges, ex-CBI chief to probe NEET protest violence

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 18

The Supreme Court on Tuesday said it would constitute a high-powered committee of retired Supreme Court and high court judges, a former DGP and a former CBI director to examine allegations of police excesses during the July 20 student protest in Delhi, as well as violence against police personnel. The panel will also examine complaints of sexual assault, online harassment of women protesters and alleged targeting of vulnerable persons through



social media. A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, along with Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, said the committee would conduct a fact-finding exercise and provide an immediate hearing to victims who approach it. The court said its order setting up the panel would be issued on Wednesday. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Tata Sons AGM adjourned due to lack of quorum

Mumbai, August 18

The annual general meeting of Tata Sons, the holding company of the \$180-billion Tata Group, was adjourned on Tuesday after the required quorum could not be met, sources said. It was the first time in more than a century that the company's AGM could not proceed.

The meeting, scheduled for 2.30 pm, could not be held because Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) were unable to nominate a representative. The two trusts hold 23.56 per cent and 27.98 per cent, respectively, in Tata Sons and together account for more than 51 per cent of the company. **CONTINUED ON P4**

STP PROJECTS TENDER CASE

Satyendar Jain, ex-DJB CEO among 6 arrested

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 18

Former Delhi minister and AAP leader Satyendar Jain and former Delhi Jal Board (DJB) CEO Udit Prakash Rai were among six people arrested by the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) on

Tuesday in a case alleging irregularities and manipulation in the tendering of sewage treatment plant (STP) projects in the capital. The arrests followed an investigation into alleged corruption, criminal conspiracy and financial wrongdoing in the tender process.

The other accused are Ankit Srivastava, a former contractual consultant with the DJB, Nagendra Yadav of AN Enterprises, Raja Kumar Kurra of Euroteck Environment Pvt Ltd and Pankaj Verma of Srijanhar. The case was registered on May 11, 2024, following **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

MP: 8 labourers killed in a road mishap in Bhind

BHIND (MP): Eight labourers from Uttar Pradesh were killed and 32 others injured when the pickup vehicle they were travelling in collided head-on with a dumper truck in Madhya Pradesh's Bhind district early Tuesday, police said.

The accident took place around 1 am near Chhimka village on the Bhind-Gwalior National Highway. The labourers were returning to their **CONTINUED ON P4**

Dabholkar case: HC grants bail to convict

MUMBAI: The Bombay High Court on Tuesday suspended the life sentence of Sachin Andure, convicted in the 2013 murder of rationalist Narendra Dabholkar, and granted him bail, observing that the evidence against him was "extremely weak" and that there were fair chances of his eventual acquittal. **CONTINUED ON P4**

SIT clears Rai in Ram Temple donation case

AYODHYA (UP): The first report of the Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing alleged theft of donations at the Ayodhya Ram Temple has cleared former Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust general secretary Champat Rai, people familiar with the developments said. **CONTINUED ON P4**

'CANDIDATES CAN SEEK LEGAL RECOURSE' JSSC-CGL cancellation leaves 2,000 appointees facing job uncertainty

MPOST BUREAU
Ranchi, August 18

The Jharkhand government's decision to cancel the JSSC-Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination has left at least 2,000 candidates who secured government jobs through the test facing uncertainty over their appointments. The successful candidates, many of whom



have already joined service, are demanding that the alleged irregularities

be investigated without cancelling the examination and their appointments.

"We were appointed after a court order. We have come with all documents. Don't cancel it. Probe it. Do a CBI probe or whatever investigation you deem fit, but please don't do injustice to us," said Kaushal Kumar, an assistant section officer, while protesting outside the Jharkhand **CONTINUED ON P4**

Police 'pick up' AAP MLA, releases him hours later

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 18

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday disposed of a habeas corpus petition concerning AAP MLA Kuldeep Kumar after Delhi Police told the court that he had been released at around 3:48 pm. Kumar had allegedly been picked up from his East Delhi resi-



dence early in the morning. Senior advocate Shaadan Farasat mentioned the matter before a bench comprising Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia, seeking an urgent hearing. The petition was filed by Kumar's wife. Farasat told the court that about 20 men in plain clothes

SC upholds hanging as valid death penalty method

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 18

The Supreme Court on Tuesday declined to order a change in the method of executing death sentences, holding that hanging remains constitutionally valid for civilian offenders under ordinary criminal law, while leaving open the possibility of **CONTINUED ON P4**

No Khel Ratna for 2025; Sports Ministry cuts Arjuna list to 17

Tejaswin, Divya and Gayatri Gopichand among Arjuna awardees

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 18

The Sports Ministry on Tuesday decided not to confer the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna, the country's highest sporting honour, on any athlete for 2025, while approving only 17 Arjuna Awardees from the 24 names recommended by the selection committee. The decision followed an unprecedented re-evaluation of the panel's recommendations, more than six months after they were made, with the

AWARDEES

- » **Arjuna Awards:** Tejaswin Shankar (Athletics), Priyanka Goswami (Athletics), Narender (Boxing), Vidit Gujrathi (Chess), Divya Deshmukh (Chess), Dhanush Srikanth (Deaf Shooting), Rajkumar Pal (Hockey), Surjeet (Kabaddi), Rudransh Khandelwal (Para-Shooting), Ekta Bhyani (Para-athletics), Arvind Singh (Rowing), Akhil Sheoran (Shooting), Treasa Jolly (Badminton), Gayatri Gopichand (Badminton), Lalremsiami (Hockey), Muhammed Ajmal (Athletics), Pooja (Kabaddi).
- » **Arjuna Awards (Lifetime):** Shri I Arumainayagam (Football)
- » **Dronacharya Award:** Parveer Singh, Chhote Lal Yadav, Neha Chavan
- » **Dronacharya Award (Lifetime):** Dharmendra Yadav, Virender Kumar.

ministry saying the exercise was intended to ensure that only deserving names were honoured

and to "preserve the integrity of the awards." It is the first time since 2014 that no athlete **CONTINUED ON P4**

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Bus boost: 200 e-buses, 56 spl buses for women

5 electric buses to link Delhi-Karnal route

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, 18 August

The Delhi government on Tuesday announced a major expansion of the Capital's public transport network with the induction of 200 new electric buses, the launch of an interstate electric bus service to Karnal, introduction of 56 women-only bus services and the inauguration of a high-capacity public EV charging station at Rajghat Depot-I.

With the addition of the new buses, Delhi's total bus fleet will rise to around 6,800, including 4,938 electric buses and 1,750 CNG buses. The newly inducted fleet comprises 88 12-metre electric buses and 112 nine-metre DEVI buses equipped with CCTV cameras, panic buttons, real-time tracking and accessibility features for persons with disabilities.

Transport Minister Dr. Pankaj Kumar Singh said, "Delhi's transport system is moving decisively towards cleaner, safer and more reliable public mobility, with electric buses at the heart of this transformation." He added that the city is implementing a time-bound fleet augmentation programme and the total bus fleet is projected to reach nearly 14,000 by FY 2028-29.

The government will also launch five fully electric air-conditioned buses on the Delhi-Karnal route. The service will operate 10 daily trips in each direction



GREEN COMMUTE

- » With the addition of the new buses, Delhi's total bus fleet will rise to around 6,800, including 4,938 electric buses and 1,750 CNG buses
- » The newly inducted fleet comprises 88 12-metre electric buses and 112 nine-metre DEVI buses equipped with CCTV cameras, panic buttons, real-time tracking and accessibility features for persons with disabilities
- » 'Our objective is not merely to add buses, but to create a transport system that is cleaner, safer, more comfortable and accessible for every citizen'

across the 133-km corridor connecting ISBT Kashmiri Gate with Karnal via Singhu Border, Rai, Murthal, Ganaur, Samalkha, Panipat, Gharaunda and Madhuban. The new route expands DTC's interstate electric network, which already connects Delhi with Baraut, Sonipat, Dharuhera, Panipat and Rohtak.

To improve women's safety and convenience, DTC will introduce 56 dedicated Ladies Special electric bus services, including 30 trips on 15 high-demand routes and 26 University Ladies Special trips covering major colleges across Delhi. The services will be operated entirely with elec-

tric DEVI buses and identified through distinctive stickers.

The Transport Department also inaugurated a public EV charging station at Rajghat Depot-I, built at a cost of about Rs.5.5 crore. Equipped with four 240-kW chargers and a 1,600-KVA substation, the facility can charge heavy commercial electric vehicles as well as electric cars.

Calling the initiatives a comprehensive mobility push, Singh said, "Our objective is not merely to add buses, but to create a transport system that is cleaner, safer, more comfortable and accessible for every citizen."

Dengue reports: MCD, Delhi govt differ

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 18 August

Delhi has recorded 246 dengue, 80 malaria and 19 chikungunya cases so far this year till August 14, with no deaths reported due to any of the three vector-borne diseases, according to the latest MCD report.

Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Singh had said on August 6 that 1,379 dengue cases were reported in the national capital till then.

PTI reached out to Dr Ashok Rawat, Medical Health Officer, Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), for an explanation on the

discrepancy in the data, but no response was received.

The weekly report suggests that the number of dengue and malaria cases reported so far this year is lower than the corresponding period in 2025, while that of chikungunya cases is also relatively low.

The data states that Delhi had recorded 354 dengue, 165 malaria and 27 chikungunya cases by the corresponding period last year. In 2024, the figures stood at 374, 155 and 26 respectively.

In the week ending August 14, the civic authorities reported 16 fresh den-

gue cases, nine malaria cases and three chikungunya cases. Of the 246 dengue cases reported this year, 223 were recorded in MCD areas, four within the New Delhi Municipal Council's (NDMC) jurisdiction, 13 in the Delhi Cantonment area and six in railway areas.

Among the MCD zones, the West Zone reported the highest number of dengue cases at 40, followed by the Central Zone with 31 and Shahdara North with 24.

For malaria, 77 of the 80 cases were reported from MCD areas, with the West Zone recording the high-

est number at 17, followed by the South Zone with 13.

Eighteen of the 19 chikungunya cases were reported from MCD areas.

The report also recorded 86 dengue, 45 malaria and four chikungunya cases as having been acquired from outside Delhi. The addresses of 151 dengue, 43 malaria and eight chikungunya patients were either incomplete or could not be traced. Civic agencies have stepped up preventive measures to check mosquito breeding, with domestic breeding checkers visiting 2,38,89,821 houses till August 14. Mosquito

breeding was detected in 91,217 households during these inspections, while 74,591 legal notices were issued for conditions conducive to mosquito breeding and 6,724 prosecutions initiated. The civic body also sprayed a larvicide at 3,20,731 houses as part of its vector-control measures. Larvivorous fish, which feed on mosquito larvae, were found surviving at 229 locations. In the corresponding period in 2023, Delhi had reported 653 dengue, 110 malaria and 16 chikungunya cases, while the figures in 2022 stood at 178, 39 and 13 respectively.

DELHI LAKSHMI YOJANA Letters from Aug 26, Rs 2,500 from Sept 1

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, 18 August

The Delhi government will begin distributing official pension letters to eligible beneficiaries of the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana from August 26, with the monthly financial assistance set to be credited directly into beneficiaries' bank accounts from September 1, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced on Tuesday.

Reviewing the scheme's implementation at the Delhi Secretariat, Gupta directed district-level committees to expedite verification of applications while ensuring thorough scrutiny to prevent ineligible claims. She also said the government would introduce a correction facility on the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana portal to allow applicants to

“THE UNPRECEDENTED SUPPORT RECEIVED FROM WOMEN IN SUCH A SHORT PERIOD IS HISTORIC

rectify incorrect or incomplete information.

The Chief Minister said nearly eight lakh women had registered on the portal within 18 days of the scheme's launch, while over five lakh applications had been finally submitted.

"The unprecedented support received from women in such a short period is historic," Gupta said, adding that the response reflected growing trust in the government's women empowerment initiative.

WORKERS' PROTEST



Municipal Corporation of Gurugram (MCG) sanitation workers stage a protest against the state government for the reinstatement of laid-off workers, and regularisation of sanitation, sewer, horticulture and other contractual workers and recruitment against vacant posts, in Gurugram, on Tuesday

PTI

Briefs

Delhi looks to Amaravati

NEW DELHI: Delhi Industries Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the government is studying Andhra Pradesh's Amaravati model to identify practices that could help modernise Delhi's industrial areas and strengthen long-term urban planning. Sirsa, accompanied by senior Delhi government officials, visited Vijayawada where the delegation met Andhra ministers Nara Lokesh and T.G. Bharath and held discussions with officials of the Capital Region Development Authority, Andhra Pradesh Industrial Infrastructure Corporation and other agencies.

Creche must at sites with 50+ workers

NOIDA: The Gautam Buddh Nagar district administration on Tuesday directed all construction sites and developers employing 50 or more workers to establish creche facilities within 15 days. The requirement was sought based on Section 24 of the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020 and Rule 58 of the Central Rules, 2026. District Magistrate Medha Ropam directed the owners, developers and builders of such construction sites to ensure that creches are accessible to all construction workers and employees and are located away from dust, smoke and other hazards.

Delhi's master plan proposes solar, hydro power generation from canals and drains

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, 18 August

To enhance the renewable energy capacity of the national capital in the future, the Master Plan of Delhi for 2047 (MPD-2047) proposes utilising existing canals and drains to generate renewable energy.

Approved by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) last week, the draft plan has been sent to the Centre for further approval. It also proposes the use of more greenfield areas under the 'agriculture-solar farm scheme', and that bus depots and metro stations should meet

their power requirements through renewable energy sources.

"Delhi has a number of canals and drains that can be utilised for harnessing solar and hydro energy as per feasibility. The concerned agencies are to leverage this potential for generation of energy as per feasibility," the draft reads.

Last year, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced a 'green budget', promising a renewed push for solar power generation in the national capital, and a separate budget was also allocated to create supporting infrastructure. The MPD suggestions are in line with

the Delhi government's earlier announcement to install solar panels along the Najafgarh drain to generate power.

According to officials, one of the projects that the Delhi government is currently exploring is the installation of solar panels along the Najafgarh drain over a six-kilometre stretch from the Dhansa Border to Ghummanhera.

"Government buildings and institutional campuses with a rooftop area above 500 sqm to install solar panels as per Delhi Solar Policy," the draft states.

Recently, power minister Ashish Sood said that

under the Delhi Solar Policy, the government is considering reducing the upfront cost through subsidies and advance payment of generation-based incentive to consumers.

Generation-based incentive is a way to reward power producers for generating clean energy. Under the existing policy, there is a combined subsidy of Rs 1.08 lakh (Rs 78,000 from the central government and Rs 30,000 by the Delhi government) on installing a 3-KW capacity rooftop plant. According to officials, the cost of installation of a 3-KW plant comes to around Rs 2.25 lakh.

Govt rejigs Class 9 academic framework

New rules bring compulsory vocational edu, optional advanced tests...

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, 18 August

The Delhi Directorate of Education (DoE) has overhauled the academic and assessment framework for Class 9 from the 2026-27 session, making vocational education a compulsory subject, introducing optional advanced assessments in Mathematics and Science, and revising promotion norms.

Under the new structure, students will be evaluated in six core subjects, Language 1, Language 2, Mathematics, Science, Social Science and Vocational Education. The inclusion of vocational education is aimed at exposing students to practical skills and career-oriented learning at an early stage.

Students will also continue studying a third language as part of the three-language formula followed in Class 8. Schools will conduct its assessment, with students being graded as "Qualified" or "Not Qualified". While failing the third-language assessment will not automatically prevent promotion to Class 10, students must clear it before they are eligi-



REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE

ble to appear for the Class 10 board examinations.

The DoE has also introduced optional advanced assessments in Mathematics and Science for students seeking greater academic challenge. These one-hour, 25-mark tests will evaluate conceptual understanding and higher-order thinking beyond the prescribed syllabus. The scores will not be counted towards promotion or the overall percentage, but students

securing at least 50 per cent will have the achievement recorded on their marksheets. The revised policy also does away with the Mathematics Basic and Mathematics Standard distinction for students entering Class 9 from 2026-27, although the existing system will continue for Class 10 students during the same academic year.

For promotion to Class 10, students must obtain at least 33 per cent separately in internal or prac-

OVERHAUL

- » Under the new structure, students will be evaluated in six core subjects, Language 1, Language 2, Mathematics, Science, Social Science and Vocational Education
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- » Students will also continue studying a third language as part of the three-language formula followed in Class 8

tical and external assessments in each of the six main subjects, along with a minimum of 25 per cent in the annual examination. Those failing in up to three subjects will be eligible for compartment examinations, while students who do not meet the prescribed criteria will have to repeat Class 9.

In addition, Art Education, Physical Education and Well-Being, and Individuals in Society will remain compulsory curricular areas.

13 DDCs for Delhi's 13 districts

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, 18 August

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar T.S. Sandhu has approved a major overhaul of the Apex Committee and District Development Committees (DDCs), expanding the district level governance framework from nine to 13 committees in line with the Capital's reorganisation into 13 revenue districts.

The revised structure also brings the Principal Secretary of the Public Works Department (PWD) into the Apex Committee as a permanent member, a move aimed at strengthening coordination in the planning and execution of major infrastructure proj-

ects across the city.

The changes partially modify the framework that was originally established on November 15, 1999.

According to the revised arrangement, the Apex Committee will continue to be chaired by the Chief Minister and will include all Cabinet Ministers, chairpersons of the 13 DDCs, the Chief Secretary, the Chairman of the Standing Committee of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and senior officials from key departments such as Finance, Urban Development, Planning, General Administration, MCD, NDMC and the Delhi Jal Board.

The Vice Chairman of

the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has also been made a regular member of the committee, while the Secretary (Revenue)-cum-Divisional Commissioner will serve as Member-Secretary.

The restructuring is intended to strengthen coordination among departments and agencies while improving monitoring at the district level. The DDC framework brings together elected representatives, civic bodies and departmental officials to facilitate local decision-making, ensure time-bound implementation of civic projects and improve grievance redressal and public service delivery across Delhi.

Narela set to become Delhi's housing hub

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, 18 August

Narela is set to emerge as a new housing hub in Delhi, with the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) planning to dispose of around 34,000 unsold flats in the area within the next two years. The move comes as the authority sees rising demand for housing in Narela, where it has already sold around 18,000 flats over the last three years.

According to official details, the DDA plans to take up the disposal of the remaining inventory in a time-bound manner over the next two years, as demand for flats in Narela continues to grow. The area is also expected to see the development of better housing societies and various amenities, further strengthening its position as an emerging residential hub.

Under the Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) policy, affordable housing is also planned in the area. Developer entities will be eligible for enhanced Floor Area Ratio (FAR), with the permissible FAR ranging from 400 to a maximum of 500, subject to applicable charges. At least 65 per cent of the built-up housing component will have to be used for residential purposes, comprising affordable housing segments with carpet areas of less than 60 square metres. Another 25 per cent will be earmarked for premium segments, while the remaining 10 per cent will be used for local level commercial facilities and social amenities. The model is expected to support a mix of housing categories along with facilities required at the local level.

The DDA is also looking beyond Narela for its future housing inventory.

Govt: 4-tier paper checking system, new experts, CISF-secured offices

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

The government on Tuesday announced a major overhaul of the examination system at the National Testing Agency, including a four-tier paper checking process, removal of 600 experts along with onboarding of new ones and CISF-secured office premises. Under fire over the recent lapses in the UGC-

NET papers and earlier the NEET-UG exam paper leak, the Education Ministry has gone into overdrive to set things in order. After a meeting chaired on Monday by Education minister Pralhad Joshi, who came in after his predecessor Dharmendra Pradhan had to resign following protests over the NEET-UG paper fiasco, the Ministry announced this evening that Joshi had



Union Education minister Pralhad Joshi reviews structural reforms at the NTA during a meeting at the Ministry of Education, in New Delhi PTI

structural facilities should be put in place for the smooth conduct of examinations. Following directions from the Minister, NTA Director General Abhishek Singh apprised the ministry of actions taken by the Agency, which is responsible for several examinations in the country. “A revamp of the examination team was undertaken with 600 experts being removed and new

experts being onboarded,” the ministry said while listing out the steps taken so far. A four-tier question paper checking system will also be put in place to strengthen the scrutiny of examination papers, it added. Besides, 20-25 officials will be inducted in the next two to three weeks, while further induction plan was also reviewed. Also, NTA offices will be

shifted to new premises on a war-footing, where security will be reinforced with CISF teams, the ministry said. Sources said the NTA office will be moved to Minto Road from Okhla in the national capital. The decisions come after the NTA faced renewed flak from Opposition parties and several protesting student groups following the Sunday night announcement of

the re-test for the UGC-NET examination for scholars. They were demanding that the NTA be scrapped, saying its “repeated lapses” have put students’ academic and career plans at risk. NTA sources, however, asserted that it had acted in the interest of students and said internal processes and protocols are being reviewed to ensure that all exams are fair and error-free in the future.

From page 1 PM CARES

The accumulated corpus continued to generate substantial interest income. Fixed deposits earned Rs 469.37 crore and savings bank accounts generated Rs 5.77 crore, taking total interest income to Rs 475.14 crore. The fund also received Rs 13.49 lakh as a refund of tax deducted at source on fixed deposit interest. Interest earnings during the year were therefore almost equal to the fresh domestic donations. The accounts also record Rs 324.66 crore as “Refund from Implementing Agencies”, nearly four times the Rs 84.31 crore returned during the previous financial year. The one-page statement does not identify the agencies involved or explain why the money was returned or what the original payments were for. The statement carries a reference to “Note 11” against the refund entry and says that accompanying notes numbered 1 to 16 form part of the financial statements. However, those notes were not uploaded along with the one-page statement.

Transparency activist Anjali Bhardwaj questioned the lack of details surrounding the refunds and asked which agencies had returned the money, why the refunds were made and what the original payments were meant for. She also questioned why the accompanying notes were not available with the statement.

“A fund set up to help citizens during disasters, which has accumulated thousands of crores (including from foreign sources), is shrouded in secrecy,” Bhardwaj wrote on X.

The timing of the accounts has also attracted attention. The financial year ended on March 31, 2025, but the audited statement carries signatures dated August 6 and 7, 2026. Pune-based Chartered Accountant Atul Modani said the audits for 2023-24 and 2024-25 appeared to have been carried out together after a gap of nearly two years. He also pointed to the absence of a Unique Document Identification Number, or UDIN, on the uploaded statement and said this could be an oversight that should be corrected. Chartered Accountant Ruchita Vaghani also questioned the gap between the money received by the fund and its expenditure.

The PM CARES Fund was created during the Covid-19 pandemic with the stated objective of dealing with emergencies and distress situations and providing relief to affected people. Its objectives include responding to public health emergencies and natural or man-made disasters, upgrading healthcare infrastructure, supporting research and providing financial assistance.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi is the ex-officio chairman of the fund. According to the Centre, PM CARES is funded entirely through voluntary contributions and does not receive budgetary support. The fund has been used for emergency healthcare measures, including setting up oxygen plants and procuring ventilators during the Covid-19 crisis.

In 2021-22, Rs 1,703 crore was spent on pressure-swing adsorption oxygen plants and Rs 835 crore on ventilators, out of total expenditure of nearly Rs 1,938 crore.

In August 2020, the Supreme Court rejected a plea seeking transfer of PM CARES funds to the NDRF, holding that the two were “entirely different funds with different objects and purposes”. The court also noted that

while the NDRF is audited by the CAG, PM CARES, as a public charitable trust, did not require a CAG audit on that basis.

The latest accounts provide details of the fund’s corpus, income and expenditure for 2024-25, while also leaving several questions about individual financial entries to be addressed through the accompanying notes and further disclosures.

Top Court

after receiving suggestions from the parties on its remaining members.

The bench said it was considering exercising its plenary powers under Article 142 to quash FIRs involving students where there was no controversy or doubt. It asked Solicitor General Tushar Mehta to provide details of such cases.

“It is the life of students, which is at stake. We have to consider this. They have a future ahead. They have the right to protest under Article 19,” the bench said while hearing opposition to the proposed quashing of cases unless students apologised.

The court said peaceful protest and expression of dissent are protected under Article 19, while questions involving facial recognition, surveillance, privacy and Article 21 would ultimately be decided by the court itself. The committee, it said, would only determine factual issues, including whether the police used excessive force.

The panel will also receive video footage and CCTV recordings of the violence during the Parliament march. Petitioners alleged that police used surveillance, facial recognition and other digital tracking methods and stored related data with a private entity. Mehta said facial recognition was used only to flag people whose details were already linked to grave crimes in National Crime Records Bureau databases.

In its affidavit, Delhi Police said more than 30,000 people had gathered around Jantar Mantar on July 20 and claimed the protest was later taken over by anti-social elements and history-sheeters. Police said force was used after repeated warnings failed to stop protesters from moving towards Parliament, and more than 240 personnel were injured.

The affidavit said records of 2,873 protesters matched existing crime records. Of them, 92 had been involved in more than 10 criminal cases and 47 were classified as history-sheeters.

Police maintained that peaceful protest is a fundamental right but said violence, injuries and damage to public property created the circumstances in which force was used. The force also told the court it would cooperate fully with any committee appointed to examine its actions.

The agitation, led by the Cockroach Janta Party, began at Jantar Mantar on June 20 and spread to several cities, with protesters demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. It was called off on July 25 after Pradhan resigned and the government accepted the BJP’s other demands. The Supreme Court had on August 3 clarified that “criminal antecedents” referred only to those involved in grave and heinous offences and said states could close or withdraw FIRs against other students in accordance with law.

Tata Sons

Article 86 of Tata Sons’ Articles of Association requires at least five members to be personally present, including a representative jointly nominated by

SRTT and SDTT, as long as the two trusts together hold at least 40 per cent.

SRTT is currently under instructions from the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner not to take major decisions or hold meetings. The directive is linked to a dispute over lifetime trustees. Three of its six trustees, Jimmy Naval Tata, Jehangir HC Jehangir and Noel Naval Tata, are lifetime or permanent trustees.

The AGM was expected to consider Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran’s directorship. Chandrasekaran has said he does not want to be considered for reappointment when his term ends in February. The meeting was also to approve the company’s standalone and consolidated financial statements for the year ended March 31, 2026, and declare a dividend.

Chandrasekaran and Anita George attended at Bombay House, while Noel Tata joined virtually. Chandrasekaran left at 4.30 pm without speaking to the media. No date was announced for the next AGM.

Satyendar Jain

a complaint by the Directorate of Vigilance under provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, and other penal laws.

According to the ACB, tender documents for augmentation and upgradation of STPs, including a project at Rohini, contained restrictive technical specifications and conditions that favoured Euroteck Environment Pvt Ltd and reduced competition. The agency alleged that a proposed pilot study was not carried out, while specifications relating to technology and media were inserted into the tender. It also alleged that key treated-effluent parameters were left out and technical conditions were later modified, causing financial implications for the government.

The investigation allegedly found communication and meetings involving private firms, public servants and intermediaries. The ACB said emails and electronic records showed tender conditions, corrigendums and other documents being circulated before their incorporation into the DJB’s tender notice.

The agency also alleged that money was routed through intermediary entities, including AN Enterprises and Srijanhar. It said Rs 1.52 crore was transferred to Rai and his relatives through AN Enterprises and was allegedly used to purchase immovable property. The ACB is examining the wider money trail and alleged proceeds of crime.

After Jain’s arrest, AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal alleged that he was detained at the behest of the BJP and claimed the case would eventually be proved “fake”. He questioned who would compensate Jain for the time spent in jail and alleged that the BJP was “falsely implicating people”. The ACB said further investigation was underway.

JSSC-CGL

Secretariat on Tuesday. The government announced late Monday that it would scrap the JSSC-CGL examination and all recruitment tests conducted by outsourced agency TSR Data Processing Pvt Ltd (TDPL) since 2014. The decision followed more than two weeks of protests led by the JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch over alleged irregularities and corruption in recruitment examinations.

The cancellation was among the protesters’ key demands, but it has now triggered a separate protest by successful candidates. They said they were not

against an investigation and also sought a CBI probe but wanted an opportunity to defend themselves before any action was taken against their appointments.

Chanda Kumari, one of the appointees, questioned whether the successful candidates had been given adequate time to present their case. “Democracy means that 100 guilty may be spared, but no innocent should be punished,” she said.

Kumari said she came from a poor background and had cleared the 14th JPSC examination and the forest range officer mains examination through hard work. Rejecting the suggestion that all appointees had benefited from malpractice, she said, “We could not have bought all these jobs.”

The candidates also cited earlier legal proceedings involving the recruitment process. They said the examination had undergone investigation and judicial scrutiny and that the High Court, in its December judgment, had rejected a demand for a CBI probe, finding the existing SIT investigation adequate.

S K Singh, another appointee, said many candidates had waited for years and joined their posts after court proceedings. “You cannot throw us out without any rhyme or reason,” he said.

Kumar claimed more than 500 appointees had left Central government jobs to join state service. He cited one candidate who resigned from a Level-6 post in the India Meteorological Department after securing the Jharkhand appointment.

The government has said the cancellation is intended to restore confidence in the recruitment system. Higher and Technical Education Minister Sudhivya Kumar said the affected candidates could seek legal remedies, while JMM spokesperson Manoj Pandey said the party was “sympathetic to them”. He said fresh vacancies would offer opportunities to deserving candidates and referred to a judicial inquiry headed by a retired judge.

Chief Minister Hemant Soren also announced an exam reforms committee headed by senior IAS officer Amitabh Kaushal. The panel will recommend measures to strengthen recruitment examinations, while the government plans stricter enforcement of laws against unfair means in exams.

Police ‘pick up’

had taken Kumar away around 4.30 am while he was protesting the death of sanitation worker Anil, who was killed while on duty in Kalyanpuri. Police, however, said Kumar had been detained around 5.15 am and released at 3.48 pm. AAP leaders had raised concerns over his whereabouts. Party convener Arvind Kejriwal alleged that police broke CCTV cameras at Kumar’s home and took away the DVR.

Former Delhi chief minister Atishi said police had not provided information about Kumar and announced that AAP would approach the High Court with a habeas corpus plea at 2 pm.

Delhi unit president Saurabh Bharadwaj also alleged that police took Kumar away and pressured the deceased worker’s family to proceed with the cremation.

AAP leaders linked Kumar’s detention to protests demanding 1 crore compensation for Anil’s family and a permanent government job for one family member.

SC upholds

adopting a different method if scientific and technological developments offer a way to reduce suffering and preserve the dignity of condemned prisoners. A bench of Justices Vikram Nath

and Sandeep Mehta dismissed a challenge to hanging but said the method must operate within constitutional safeguards.

The court said the State, even when legally authorised to take a life, cannot carry out the punishment in a manner that is “arbitrary, excessive, or incompatible with human dignity”. It said the method of execution must minimise suffering as far as possible, noting that the death penalty is unique because its consequences are final and irreversible.

The petition was filed by senior advocate Rishi Malhotra, appearing in person, who challenged Section 354(5) of the Code of Criminal Procedure, now reflected in Section 393(5) of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023. The provision requires a death sentence to be carried out by hanging. Malhotra argued that hanging was an archaic and painful method and violated the right to life with dignity under Article 21. He sought its replacement with a more humane method, including allowing death row prisoners a choice in execution.

The bench found no basis to reconsider the Supreme Court’s 1983 Constitution Bench ruling in Deena @ Deena Dayal vs Union of India, which upheld hanging as a valid method of execution. It also rejected reliance on the Army Act, Air Force Act and Navy Act, which allow death sentences in certain circumstances to be carried out by hanging or shooting. The court said those laws apply to persons governed by military law and cannot be used to test provisions applicable to civilians.

The court traced hanging as the statutory method to the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1861, which introduced “hanging by the neck” as the sole mode of execution. It noted that the long-drop method was introduced at the time as a humanitarian reform, based on calculations involving the prisoner’s height and weight.

The issue has been before the Supreme Court since 2017. The court had then asked the Centre to explore less painful alternatives. In May 2023, the Union government said it was considering an expert committee, but the bench noted that no subsequent update showed that such a committee had actually been constituted.

The Union has opposed lethal injection, calling hanging the “safest and quickest” method and citing botched executions in the United States. The Supreme Court said Tuesday’s dismissal does not prevent future scrutiny based on scientific knowledge or technological developments, leaving the government free to examine alternatives that could minimise unnecessary pain while preserving dignity.

No Khel

has received the Khel Ratna. Hockey player Hardik Singh had been considered for the Khel Ratna by the committee headed by former Supreme Court judge Arun Kumar Mishra but did not make the final cut. The selection panel included Indian Olympic Association Vice-President Gagan Narang, former badminton player Aparna Popat and former hockey player M M Somaya.

The Arjuna list includes 19-year-old chess player Divya Deshmukh, the first Indian woman to win the World Cup, along with Grandmaster Vidit Gujrathi, who was part of India’s gold-winning team at the 2024 Chess Olympiad. Decathlete and high jumper Tejaswin Shankar, badminton player Gayatri Gopichand and her women’s doubles partner Treesa Jolly are also among the awardees.

Other recipients include Glasgow Commonwealth Games silver medallist boxer Narendra Berwal in the +92kg category and deaf rifle shooter Dhanush Srikanth.

Shankar had criticised the delay in announcing the awards, describing it as disrespectful to athletes. He won a historic decathlon silver at the 2023 Asian Games, followed it with a second-place finish at the Asian Championships last year and recently secured a Commonwealth Games bronze despite a knee problem.

Only two para-athletes have made this year’s Arjuna list, compared with 17 of the record 32 recipients in 2024. They are para club thrower Ekta Bhyani, a 2024 Para World Championships gold medallist who also won silver at last year’s event in Delhi, and shooter Rudransh Khandelwal, a 2024 Para World Cup gold medallist. No cricketer has been selected, continuing a trend since Mohammed Shami received the award in 2023.

I Arumainayagam, a member of India’s 1962 Asian Games gold-winning football team, is the sole recipient of the Arjuna Award for Lifetime Achievement.

Three Dronacharya Awardees were also named. Boxing coach Chhote Lal Yadav, who has worked with the women’s national camp and legendary boxer M C Mary Kom’s support staff, is among them. Dharmendra Yadav, coach of the men’s national squad, and wrestling coach Virender Kumar received the Lifetime Achievement honour in coaching. The Khel Ratna carries a medalion, citation and Rs 25 lakh, while the Arjuna Award carries Rs 15 lakh. Last year, D Gukesh, Harmanpreet Singh, Praveen Kumar and Manu Bhaker received the Khel Ratna.

The awards are traditionally presented on August 29, National Sports Day and Major Dhyan Chand’s birth anniversary. However, the date has varied since the pandemic. Last year’s ceremony was held on January 17. The 2025 awards announcement, made after more than half of 2026 has passed, marks the longest delay since the awards were instituted in 1991.

MP: 8 labourers

villages in Lakhimpur Kheri after completing paddy transplantation work in Gwalior.

Gohad Chauraha police station in-charge Ramnaresh Yadav said the preliminary investigation suggested that the pickup driver lost control while trying to avoid cattle sitting on the highway. The vehicle moved into the wrong direction and crashed into the dumper coming from the opposite side.

The impact severely damaged the pickup and trapped several workers inside. Five labourers died at the spot, while three others succumbed to their injuries while being taken to hospital. Police and local residents rescued those trapped in the wreckage.

The injured were taken to a hospital in Gohad for first aid, while those in serious condition were referred to Gwalior.

Kheri Superintendent of Police Khyati Garg confirmed the eight deaths. The deceased were identified as Updesh, Amar Singh, Sukhdev, Rajneesh and Bhure Lal, all aged 30 to 45 and from Bela Tursiya village, along with Subhash, 30, of Harna Neoli, Guddu, 45, of Kishanpur Aji, and Madan Pal of Shahjahanpur.

Ankit, son of Bela Tursiya village head Sarla Devi, said five of the deceased and 11 injured were from the village.

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath announced Rs 2

lakh each for the families of the deceased. He also directed officials to coordinate with Madhya Pradesh authorities for the return of the bodies and proper treatment of the injured.

MP05T

Dabholkar

A bench of Justices Sarang Kotwal and Ranjitsinha Bhonsale said two eyewitnesses identified Andure nearly eight years after the shooting, raising doubts over the reliability of the identification. The court also pointed to gaps concerning the recovery of the weapon and the ballistic expert’s opinion.

“The applicant is in custody based on a weak piece of evidence for about six years from the arrest in this case and hence, deserves to be released on bail,” the court said. It directed Andure to furnish a personal bond of Rs 50,000.

Dabholkar, 67, founder of the Maharashtra Andhashradha Nirmoolan Samiti, was shot dead by two motorcycle-borne assailants during his morning walk in Pune on August 20, 2013. The local police initially investigated the case before the probe was transferred to the CBI in 2014 following a petition by his daughter Mukta Dabholkar.

The prosecution had alleged that Andure was one of the shooters. A sessions court on May 10, 2024, convicted Andure and Sharad Kalaskar and sentenced both to life imprisonment. They were acquitted of charges under the UAPA and Arms Act.

Andure had appealed against his conviction and sought suspension of his sentence and bail. The high court allowed his interim application on Tuesday. He is also facing trial in the murder of activist Govind Pansare and can now leave jail after securing bail in both cases.

The high court had earlier acquitted Virendra Singh Tawde, Sanjiv Punalekar and Vikram Bhavare for insufficient evidence. Mukta has challenged those acquittals and the exclusion of UAPA charges against Andure and Kalaskar, alleging a wider conspiracy. Dabholkar’s killing was followed by the murders of Pansare in February 2015, MM Kalburgi in August 2015 and journalist Gauri Lankesh in September 2017.

SIT clears Rai

The Home Department has examined the report and forwarded it to the Trust for further action. The final report does not name either Rai or former Trust member Anil Mishra, according to the sources.

Rai and Mishra resigned from their positions on June 27 while the investigation into alleged irregularities in temple donations was underway.

The first SIT was formed on June 13 on the direction of Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath after the Trust sought an inquiry. Lucknow divisional commissioner Vijay Vishwas Pant headed the team, with Lucknow Range Inspector General of Police Kiran S and Special Secretary (Finance) Neel Ratan Kumar as its members. The panel submitted its preliminary report to the state government on June 23. An FIR was subsequently registered in Ayodhya on June 25 in connection with the allegations.

A separate SIT, formed under the supervision of the Supreme Court, is continuing its investigation into the case. The two inquiries are being conducted amid allegations concerning the handling of donations received for the Ram Temple.

The latest development comes as the Trust considers the first SIT’s findings and determines the next course of action.

MP05T

AFTER US PRESIDENT TRUMP’S REMARKS

MEA: Credibility of India’s poll system globally recognised

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

The credibility and strength of India’s election machinery are globally recognised, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Tuesday after US President Donald Trump cited India’s voter card system to press for domestic citizenship verification.

Making a strong case for stricter electoral laws in the US, Trump praised the Indian election apparatus and recalled Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar questioning lack of voter identification in American polls.

“I have no specific comments on these remarks. I can say, however, that the credibility and robustness of India’s election machinery is a well-established fact globally,” External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said at his bi-weekly media briefing.

He was responding to a question on Trump’s remarks.

In a social media post, Trump said over 646 million people participated in the recent general elections in India, and yet less than one per cent voted through postal ballots.

Trump said India’s chief election commissioner had spoken with officials from his administration earlier this month,



Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal addresses a bi-weekly media briefing, in New Delhi

'Close to 100 crore electors have voter cards in India'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

After US President Donald Trump cited India’s voter cards to make a case for the SAVE America Act, Election Commission officials on Tuesday said that nearly 100 crore electors have been issued ‘special’ Electoral Photo

Identity Cards (EPIC). They underlined that polling in India is held based on a photo identity card.

The ECI has issued a special EPIC to “all” electors, which are close to a billion, they said.

Electors can also download their e-EPIC from a dedicated website.

and asked how US elections can be held without a valid photo identification card.

The US president made these remarks to drum up support for the SAVE

America Act which would require Americans to show proof of citizenship to register to vote, impose a nationwide voter identification requirement and severely limit voting by

mail.

“Earlier this month, India’s Chief Election Commissioner, Gyanesh Kumar, asked our Administration - How can you have Elections in the US without a valid Photo ID,” Trump wrote.

“India’s last Election had 646,000,000 Voters! Less than one per cent voted by mail, and every single Voter had to have a VALID Photo Identity Document.”

“We need to pass THE SAVE AMERICA ACT, now,” he asserted.

Trump has been insisting on passing the Safeguard American Voter Eligibility (SAVE) America Act, claiming the move would curb electoral fraud.

Briefs

Nadda undergoes angioplasty

NEW DELHI: Union Health minister J P Nadda underwent angioplasty at AIIMS-Delhi and is stable, hospital authorities said on Tuesday.

Nadda was admitted to the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) on August 13 after experiencing uneasiness and underwent tests, including a coronary angiography, the same evening.

Kejriwal, Mann meet jailed MLA

VADODARA: AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal and Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Tuesday met tribal leader and party MLA Chaitar Vasava at Vadodara Central Jail in Gujarat, sources said.

SP protests over ‘gau mutra’...

LUCKNOW: Samajwadi Party workers staged a protest at Hazratganj crossing here on Tuesday against the proposed procurement of ‘gau mutra’ (cow urine) at Rs 10 per litre under a pilot project in Bulandshahr, officials said.

The demonstrators carried bottles of cow urine and raised slogans against the Uttar Pradesh government.

CWC meet today; roadmap to corner govt on student protests, Ram temple ‘theft’

Also, a review of preparations for upcoming Assembly elections

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

The Congress will hold a meeting of its working committee here on Wednesday to discuss the prevailing political situation in the country, including the roadmap to step up pressure on the government on issues of students and the Ram temple donation “theft”.

The Congress Working Committee (CWC) meeting will be held at Indira Bhawan at 3 pm on Wednesday, with party president Mallikarjun Kharge chairing it and top leaders, including former party chief Rahul Gandhi and general secretaries Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Jairam Ramesh and K C Venugopal, set to attend.

The Opposition party’s roadmap to corner the



Rahul Gandhi during the AICC OBC Department District Chairpersons' Conference, in New Delhi

Bharatiya Janata Party-led Centre on issues of students and the Ram temple donation “theft” would be on the agenda, sources said.

Also, a review of the party’s preparations for the Assembly polls early next year would be held. Polls are likely to take place in Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Goa and Manipur early next year.

Prime Minister Narendra

Modi’s appeal to Opposition parties to support a delimitation-linked Bill to implement women’s reservation in the Lok Sabha and state Assemblies is also likely to come up for discussion as there is a possibility that it may be brought by the government in the near future.

Asked about the possibility of the government bringing the delimitation-linked Bill for implement-

ing women’s reservation, Ramesh had last week said, “We are in touch with all parties. We continue to be in touch with all parties, I am sure that this issue will be discussed on August 19, when the CWC meets.

“We cannot afford to relax, you know, because they (govt) will try all sorts of tricks. But they do not have the numbers, and the gap between what they claim to have now and what they need is not a small gap. It is a substantial two-digit gap.”

After the last CWC meeting in April, the Congress had accused the Modi govt of playing politics in the name of the women’s-reservation law and asserted that the proposed delimitation exercise linked to it is “not constitutional” and can have “grave consequences”.

‘India desires constructive relations with B’desh based on mutuality of interests’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

India on Tuesday said it desires “positive and constructive” relations with Dhaka based on “mutuality of interests and reciprocity” amid uncertainty over Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman’s visit to New Delhi.

The ties between the two countries came under some fresh strain after former prime minister Sheikh Hasina held a virtual media interaction in New Delhi on

August 5.

Following Hasina’s press interaction, Dhaka reiterated its demand for her extradition and even sought to link it with Rahman’s possible visit to India.

“India desires positive, constructive and forward-looking relations with Bangladesh based on mutuality of interests and reciprocity,” External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said at his bi-weekly media briefing.

“Our position on the press conference by the for-

mer Bangladesh prime minister needs no repetition. On the issue of extraditions, our consistent position has been that these requests are being examined as part of our established processes,” he said.

Following Hasina’s media event, India sought to distance itself from it saying New Delhi neither played a role in it nor endorsed her comments.

Hasina, 78, was ousted from power in August 2024 following violent student-led protests.

‘THIS IS THE RIGHT WAY’

Rahul hails ‘understanding’ between J’khand govt, students

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday hailed the “understanding” reached between protesting students and the Jharkhand government, saying it was the “right way” as Chief Minister Hemant Soren chose dialogue while the students exercised restraint and got their demands accepted.

Gandhi also vowed to change the system across the country to establish a framework that propels students forward rather than holds them back.

“An understanding has been reached between the students of Jharkhand and the state government, and the students have ended their hunger strike - it was heartening to hear this news,” Gandhi said in a post in Hindi on X.

“Chief Minister Hemant Soren ji and the Jharkhand government chose the path



Jharkhand ministers serve juice to hunger-striking student leader Devendra Nath Mahto, in Ranchi

of dialogue and arrived at a solution. The students exercised restraint and made their demands accepted,” the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said.

This is the right way - when students raise questions, they should get answers, he said.

“We stand with every student in the country. And we will uproot and transform this recovery system, so that every student gets the full reward of their hard

work and the right to fair competition,” Gandhi said.

This system will change across the country, and a framework will be established that propels students forward, rather than holding them back, the former Congress chief said.

Gandhi had written to Soren, urging him to personally meet representatives of the protesting students and take appropriate action to resolve the issue.

LS witnesses rise in Bills referred to joint panels

So far, 9 Bills have been referred to joint panels since the present Lok Sabha was formed in 2024

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

The Foreign Contributions (Regulation) Amendment Bill has become the 17th draft law to be referred to a joint committee of Parliament by the Narendra Modi government since 2014, according to data.

The 18th Lok Sabha has seen a sharp rise in Bills being sent to joint committees of the two Houses.

So far, nine Bills have been referred to joint panels since the present Lok Sabha was formed in 2024, according to available statistics.

KEY POINTS

» Comparatively, four Bills each were sent to joint committees during the 16th and 17th Lok Sabhas

» The 17 Bills have involved 14 joint panel exercises, because some were referred together to the same committee

» In the first two terms of Modi, four Bills were referred to joint Parliamentary committees (JPCs) in each

Comparatively, four Bills each were sent to joint committees during the 16th and 17th Lok Sabhas.

The 17 Bills have involved 14 joint panel exercises, because some were referred together to

the same committee.

Such ‘companion’ Bills seek to achieve the same purpose together.

For example, the Bill to lay down a legal framework to hold simultaneous elections to the Lok Sabha

and state Assemblies was accompanied by a Bill to implement the proposed law in Delhi, Puducherry and Jammu and Kashmir - the three Union territories with legislative Assemblies.

Such Bills are called companion Bills.

The major referrals during the 18th Lok Sabha include the Waqf (Amendment) Bill, two One Nation, One Election Bills, three Bills concerning removal of ministers upon detention, the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishtan Bill, the Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill, and now the Foreign Contributions (Regulation)

Amendment Bill.

In the first two terms of Modi, four Bills were referred to joint Parliamentary committees (JPCs) in each.

Some were enacted, the others were withdrawn or lapsed, according to data available on the Lok Sabha website and with PRS India, a legislative think tank.

Joint committees of the two Houses and select committees of either the Lok Sabha or the Rajya Sabha are set up to examine a particular Bill and are disbanded after they submit their reports.

BJP faces people’s rejection, says Akhilesh

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Lucknow, August 18

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Tuesday claimed that the BJP was working on a seat-sharing plan for its allies ahead of the upcoming Assembly elections, but the move would fail as people have completely rejected the ruling party.

In a post on social media platform X, Yadav, citing sources, said the BJP was considering 73 seats to the Rashtriya Lok Dal, 39 to the Suheldev Bharatiya Samaj Party, 31 to the Nishad Party and 19 to Apna Dal allegedly on the advice of some election experts. Yadav said

the proposed arrangement could be seen as “commendable”, but the allocation was still less than half of the representation corresponding to the PDA (Pichhda, Dalit and Alpsankhyak) population. He said the BJP’s plan would fail because of “the govt’s record on corruption, inflation, unemployment, education, healthcare, electricity, roads and recruitment”.

Yadav accused the BJP and its allies of resorting to false cases and fake encounters, demolishing people’s houses and shops with bulldozers, failing to protect the rights of farmers, workers and professionals, and undermining reservation in recruitments.

EDITORIAL

A Flight to Fairness

India's aviation boom has transformed air travel from an occasional luxury into an increasingly routine mode of transport. Yet passenger protection has not expanded at the same pace. The Supreme Court's stern warning that airlines failing to comply with regulatory requirements could face consequences as serious as grounding therefore deserves attention. The Centre is working on new aviation rules, providing an opportunity to correct a persistent imbalance between carriers and customers. Airlines operate in a difficult industry shaped by fuel prices, airport charges, currency fluctuations and intense competition, and regulation must recognise these realities. But commercial pressures cannot justify opaque pricing, unreasonable cancellation practices, delayed refunds or inadequate assistance when flights are disrupted. A rapidly expanding aviation market needs an equally mature framework of passenger rights.

The answer, however, is not excessive government interference in airline pricing. Dynamic fares are a legitimate feature of aviation: prices rise and fall according to demand, capacity, season and proximity to departure. Artificial fare caps could discourage airlines from adding capacity and eventually hurt passengers themselves. Regulation should instead concentrate on transparency and accountability. Travellers should know the complete price of a journey before making payment, with optional services clearly distinguished from unavoidable charges. When flights are cancelled or significantly delayed, compensation and assistance should follow clear rules rather than depend on a passenger's ability to pursue an airline through call centres and emails. Refunds should be automatic within prescribed timelines. Grievance mechanisms must also become simpler. Consumer rights lose their meaning when enforcing them requires weeks of correspondence or litigation. Airlines that repeatedly violate these obligations should face financial penalties substantial enough to discourage non-compliance.

The new rules should therefore establish a passenger-first regulatory culture without undermining the commercial viability of aviation. Grounding an airline should remain an extraordinary sanction reserved for persistent or serious violations; proportional enforcement through compensation, fines and regulatory restrictions should ordinarily come first. More importantly, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation must be equipped to enforce standards proactively instead of expecting passengers to fight individual battles. India is on course to become one of the world's largest aviation markets, and policy understandably focuses on new airports, aircraft orders and regional connectivity. But infrastructure alone does not create a world-class aviation system. Its real test comes when a flight is cancelled, baggage is lost or money must be refunded. Passengers should know exactly what they are entitled to – and receive it without having to beg for it.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Idle Corpus

The PM CARES Fund's Rs 8,452-crore balance, with 93 per cent held in fixed deposits, deserves closer public scrutiny. Spending just Rs 87.85 lakh during 2024-25 raises questions about utilisation. A fund created for emergencies must ensure timely deployment, detailed disclosures and greater transparency over how public contributions are ultimately used.

ASHUTOSH RAO,
MUMBAI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post,
Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Slavery Never Really Disappeared

A century after the Slavery Convention, exploitation persists in new forms, with technology, trafficking and cybercrime creating sophisticated systems of modern bondage

SOCIAL FAULTLINES



DIPANKAR DEY

THE WRITER IS A PROFESSOR
OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

In the last week of July 2026, a sixty-eight-year-old mother travelled to Punjab from Coimbatore to bring home her 41-year-old son, who was rescued from bonded labour in Jasraur village in Amritsar, after he went missing 23 years ago. He was allegedly forced to work without wages under CCTV surveillance during the day and was locked in a room and chained at night, where he slept with cattle. He was given only two meals a day while looking after livestock. Incidentally, the reunion of the bonded labour with his mother marks the centenary year of the 1926 Slavery Convention (the Convention to Suppress the Slave Trade and Slavery), which defined slavery as the status or condition of a person over whom any or all of the powers attaching to the right of ownership are exercised. It was the first major international treaty to codify freedom from slavery as a fundamental human right, establishing the baseline for future modern human rights laws. Till now, 99 States, including India, have ratified the Slavery Con-

vention. Despite its prohibition, slavery is not merely a practice of the past; it persists globally in contemporary forms. In India, the estimated number of people in modern slavery is around 11 million. Modern slavery is an umbrella term encompassing, but not limited to, slavery, servitude, forced or compulsory labour and human trafficking.

According to the UN report, around 50 million people globally continue to be subjected to contemporary forms of slavery, like forced labour, debt bondage, descent-based slavery, serfdom, children working in slavery or slavery-like conditions, domestic servitude, sexual slavery, and servile forms of marriage. Digital platforms are increasingly used to facilitate both sexual and labour exploitation, enabling traffickers to recruit, advertise, and control victims across borders with greater anonymity and reach.

Slavery continues in countries around the world today. Published by Walk Free every five years, the Global Slavery Index (GSI) highlights the extent and location of modern slavery. GSI includes three main markers that reflect the severity of slavery within that nation:

- ▶ The prevalence of slavery per 100,000 people shows the estimated number of people in modern slavery;
- ▶ The vulnerability score shows how likely modern slavery can take hold of people within a country;
- ▶ The government response score looks at how each government works to end modern slavery.

In the Global Slavery Index 2026 (data updated in September 2025), Switzerland and Norway both tied for the lowest slavery prevalence score, 0.50. Norway also had the lowest vulnerability score, 1. The United Kingdom had the best government response



Old forms of bondage are acquiring dangerous digital dimensions

AROUND 50 MILLION PEOPLE WORLDWIDE REMAIN TRAPPED IN MODERN FORMS OF SLAVERY

rate of 68. The country with the highest slavery prevalence score (as of 2023 data) was North Korea, which had an estimated 104.60 people out of 100,000 under

modern slavery conditions. This nation also had the lowest government response score of -3. It was the only country with a negative score in this category. South Sudan had the highest vulnerability score of 100. For India, the slavery vulnerability score was 56, the slavery prevalence score was 8, and the government response score was 46. The corresponding scores for the People's Republic of China were: 46, 4, and 40, respectively.

A recent report from the UK-based Independent Anti-Slavery Commissioner highlights that artificial intelligence, digi-

tal platforms, cryptocurrencies, and encrypted communications are enabling traffickers to recruit, groom, control, and profit from victims with greater scale, speed, anonymity, and sophistication. The report also points to coercive surrogacy, egg harvesting, and related practices as emerging forms of exploitation. Rising global fertility demand, declining birth rates, and expanding cross-border reproductive markets are expected to increase incentives to coerce or deceive individuals into exploitative reproductive activities.

Cyber slavery is growing across Southeast Asia, trapping young jobseekers in brutal scam compounds. The compounds where trafficked people are forced to work have mushroomed across Asia since the pandemic, transforming Chinese and Cambodian casino areas of the 1990s into cyber slavery hubs. A 2024 report by the United States Institute of Peace estimates that cyberscams bring in USD 12.5 billion in Cambodia, USD 15.3 billion in Myanmar and USD 10.9 billion in Laos – nearly 40% of their combined GDP.

In 1846, Karl Marx theorised the relationship between slavery and modern capitalism in his seminal essay, *'The Poverty of Philosophy'*. According to him, slavery was not a peripheral but a central part of modern capitalism. Marx did not view the large-scale enslavement of Africans by Europeans, which began in the early 16th century in the Caribbean, as a repeat of Roman or Arab slavery, but as something new. It combined ancient forms of brutality with the characteristically modern social form of value production. With the introduction of innovative technology, a new and complex form of slavery is emerging for the creation of huge profit for the tech barons of the 21st century.

Views expressed are personal

Scribbles that Changed the World

From airlines to Hollywood, humble napkins have captured ideas that changed industries

CREATIVE SPARKS



KM PRASHANTH

THE WRITER IS A
FORMER GM (CORPORATE
COMMUNICATION), NTPC

We tend to think of innovation as something that happens in laboratories, corporate boardrooms or high-tech research centres, surrounded by whiteboards, presentations and sophisticated equipment. But some of the most interesting ideas in business, economics, entertainment and design began on a humble napkin.

What connects Southwest Airlines, the film *'A Few Good Men'*, the Laffer Curve, the numerical font on credit cards and the iconic Chupa Chups logo? Surprisingly, a napkin connects them all.

The stories are fascinating not merely because of where these ideas were conceived, but because they remind us of something we may be forgetting: creativity does not always require perfect conditions. Sometimes, it simply requires recognising a good idea when it appears and

capturing it before it disappears.

Take Southwest Airlines. In 1966, Rollin King, who owned a small Texas commuter airline, discussed his idea for a low-cost carrier with his lawyer, Herb Kelleher. To explain the proposed network, King reportedly drew a simple route map on a cocktail napkin. It showed what came to be known as the "Texas Triangle", linking Dallas, Houston and San Antonio.

Southwest began operations in 1971, initially serving these three cities. That modest sketch eventually evolved into one of the world's most successful low-cost airline models. A napkin had provided the first canvas for an idea that would transform air travel.

Hollywood offers another example.

Before *'A Few Good Men'* became a successful 1992 film starring Tom Cruise, Jack Nicholson and Demi Moore, it was a play written by Aaron Sorkin. While working as a bartender at a Broadway theatre during a production of *La Cage aux Folles*, Sorkin reportedly scribbled ideas on cocktail napkins and carried them home in his pockets.

Those rough notes eventually became a courtroom drama that earned four Oscar nominations and helped establish Sorkin as one of Hollywood's most acclaimed screenwriters. The journey from cocktail napkins to Hollywood is a reminder that an unfinished thought can sometimes contain the beginnings of something extraordinary.

The world of economics has its own napkin story.

In 1974, economist Arthur Laffer reportedly drew a simple graph on a napkin during a dinner with Dick Cheney and Donald Rumsfeld, then officials in the Gerald Ford administration. Laffer was explaining his argument



Big ideas sometimes begin on the smallest scraps of paper

STRUCTURE SHOULD EMPOWER CREATIVITY, NOT SUFFOCATE PROMISING IDEAS THROUGH BUREAUCRACY

that beyond a certain point, raising tax rates could actually lead to lower government revenue.

The illustration became associated with what is now known as the "Laffer Curve", a term coined by journalist Jude Wanniski, who was present at the dinner. The underlying idea was not entirely new—Laffer himself acknowledged earlier thinking on the subject, including ideas found in the writings of the 14th-century philosopher Ibn Khaldun. Yet the napkin sketch helped turn an abstract economic argument

into a simple visual proposition.

Then there is the credit card in your wallet.

In 1952, David H. Shepard, a pioneer in optical character recognition, developed the numerical typeface known as Farrington B. The distinctive, boxy numbers were designed to make characters easier for machines to recognise, particularly when credit-card information could be smudged or poorly printed.

The design was reportedly first sketched on a napkin at New York's Waldorf Astoria. Today, those numbers are instantly recognisable to millions of people around the world. Once again, a seemingly insignificant piece of paper became the starting point for a practical innovation.

And finally, there is Chupa Chups.

In 1958, Spanish confectioner Enric Bernat noticed that children often took sweets out of their mouths with their hands. His solution was wonderfully simple: put the sweet on a stick. That small change transformed the way lollipops were consumed.

When the brand later needed a distinctive visual identity, Bernat approached surrealist artist Salvador Dalí. In 1969, Dalí reportedly sketched the now-famous daisy-shaped Chupa Chups logo on a paper napkin while talking with Bernat. The simple design, with its bright colours and distinctive lettering, went on to become one of the world's most recognisable confectionery logos.

Five stories. Five industries. One unlikely common denominator.

But perhaps the real lesson is not about napkins at all.

We live in an age in which innovation is often surrounded by elaborate processes. Ideas are discussed in strategy meetings, converted into presentations, subjected to committees and evaluated through spreadsheets before they are allowed to take their first step. There is nothing wrong with structure, of course. But structure should help creativity—not suffocate it.

The napkin represents the opposite of overthinking. It is informal, inexpensive and immediate. You do not worry about formatting or perfection. You simply put the idea down.

That is perhaps why these stories continue to fascinate us. They remind us that innovation begins not with a finished product, but with curiosity. The first sketch may be crude. The first thought may be incomplete. The first attempt may even look insignificant.

What matters is what happens next.

So the next time someone reaches for a napkin, don't assume it is merely to wipe away a coffee stain or clean a pair of fingers.

It could be the first draft of something that changes the world.

Views expressed are personal

Cost of Emotion without Restraint

Shurpanakha's story is a lesson in boundaries, grievance management and the danger of allowing personal emotion to travel through institutional power

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON,
BHARAT KI SOCH

A grievance can be justified. A boundary can be crossed. Even a genuine grievance demands a measured response. The most difficult questions of leadership arise not when one side is entirely right and the other entirely wrong, but when hurt, power and judgement begin to interact. The story of Shurpanakha in the Ramayana is powerful precisely because it is not only the story of one person losing self-control. It is a chain of choices in which several individuals have opportunities to contain conflict, yet the grievance keeps widening until private emotion acquires public consequence.

In the Aranya Kanda, Shurpanakha encounters Rama, Sita and Lakshmana at Panchavati. Attracted to Rama, she expresses her desire to marry him. Rama declines, and the exchange moves towards Lakshmana, who also refuses. Shurpanakha then turns against Sita, and Lakshmana responds by disfiguring her, cutting off her nose and ears. Humiliated and injured, she seeks out Khara, whose retaliation ends in defeat. She later approaches Ravana, and what began as a personal encounter becomes part of the chain leading towards Sita's abduction and ultimately the war in Lanka.

The episode therefore invites us to look beyond a single act and examine the sequence: desire becomes entitlement, rejection is experienced as humiliation, humiliation becomes retaliation, retaliation produces injury, injury becomes grievance, and grievance is repeatedly escalated by those with the power to respond. Not everyone in this chain bears the same responsibility, but every stage raises an important question: will emotion be governed by judgement, or will judgement be governed by emotion?

What begins as attraction becomes more troubling when Shurpanakha refuses to respect the boundary before her and turns against Sita. Her conduct draws an important distinction between desire and entitlement. Desire is natural, but entitlement is what becomes dangerous. In professional life, ambition for promotion, recognition, influence or opportunity can motivate excellence. The problem begins when aspiration becomes a belief that an outcome is owed to us. A colleague's success then feels like an insult, disagreement feels like disrespect and an unfavourable decision becomes personal.

This is why rejection is such an important test of maturity. A leader may see a proposal declined, a strategy challenged or a promotion awarded elsewhere. The disciplined response is to distinguish rejection of an idea from rejection of the individual, and professional disagreement from personal disloyalty. Character is revealed not only by what we pursue, but by how we respond when we are told no. Before reacting, a useful question for any leader is: am I responding to the facts, or to a wounded ego?



Shurpanakha's story reveals the dangerous price of unchecked emotion

POWER MAY
DETERMINE HOW FAR
OUR DECISIONS TRAVEL,
BUT CHARACTER
DETERMINES THE
DIRECTION IN
WHICH THEY GO

Yet respecting boundaries is only one side of the ethical responsibility. Authority must also know how to enforce boundaries. Unwelcome or threatening conduct may require intervention, but the manner of that intervention matters. The Panchavati episode therefore raises a difficult question about proportionality. Individuals must respect boundaries, but those exercising authority must enforce them clearly, proportionately and without unnecessary humiliation. A response that ends an immediate confrontation but creates a deeper grievance may succeed in the moment and fail in the larger sense.

This has direct relevance to organisations. Public ridicule may silence an employee in a meeting, but it can also create resentment that survives long after the meeting ends. A senior may be justified in correcting misconduct, yet humiliation is rarely a substitute for discipline. Corporate systems work best when boundaries are clear, consequences are proportionate and communication preserves dignity. Self-mastery must precede leadership of others. Those who cannot govern their own anger, pride or irritation will eventually exercise authority through them.

The consequences of emotional displacement are equally serious. Shurpanakha's anger turns towards Sita, who had not caused the rejection. In workplaces, a manager rebuked by a senior may take the frustration out on juniors. Internal disappointment may be redirected towards a vulnerable colleague. Commercial disappointment may become retaliation against a competitor. Power should never be exercised simply against whoever is nearest or easiest to punish. Injustice often begins when anger chooses a convenient target rather than the responsible one.

At the same time, Shurpanakha's later injury cannot simply be ignored. By the time she approaches Khara, she has suffered real physical harm. This is where justice must resist the temptation to turn every story into a simple division between victim and wrongdoer. A person may have contributed to a confrontation and still suffer a disproportionate response. A person may suffer a genuine wrong and still respond to it unjustly. Justice must be capable of examining both truths at once.

That principle matters far beyond the Ramayana. In corporate discipline, institutional disputes and even relations between states, an initial wrong does not create an unlimited licence for revenge. Retaliation must be proportionate, evidence-based and directed towards resolution rather than endless escalation. Experiencing a wrong does not give anyone the right to create a never-ending cycle of wrongs. Justice asks what happened, who was responsible, what response is proportionate and what will prevent repetition. Revenge asks only how much pain can be returned.

What begins at Panchavati does not remain there. Shurpanakha takes her grievance to Khara. Khara responds through force, is defeated, and the matter ultimately reaches Ravana. By then, an individual grievance has expanded into a conflict involving rulers and kingdoms. Unresolved grievances rarely remain the size at which they began. Strong institutions therefore need more than grievance mechanisms on paper. They need psychological safety for the complainant, a willingness to hear every party, credible fact-finding and a process that distinguishes listening from endorsement. A person who feels wronged should be able to speak without fear of ridicule or dismissal. But hearing a grievance does not mean automatically accepting the complainant's interpretation or proposed remedy. Every party must be heard, and leadership must remain independent enough to ask what actually happened.

This is where Ravana's failure becomes especially significant. Shurpanakha approaches him as an injured and aggrieved sister. Ravana, however, must respond not merely as a brother but as a king. He has an obligation to separate affection from judgement, grievance from evidence and personal retaliation from the interests of Lanka. Instead of containing the grievance, Ravana allows it to culminate in the abduction of Sita, an act that sets in motion a chain of events ending in war and the devastation of Lanka.

Ravana's response shows what happens when a leader allows personal loyalty and private grievance to shape the exercise of public power. Instead of separating his role as a brother from his responsibility as a king, he allows the two to merge. That is where the deeper

lesson emerges: leadership fails when personal grievance becomes institutional policy. Leaders do not need to suppress emotion. Empathy, anger at injustice and loyalty can all have moral value. But emotion must not become policy without first passing through evidence, proportionality and judgement. A chief executive cannot use organisational power to settle a personal score. A senior manager cannot block a career because someone disagreed with them. Before acting, leaders should ask: Is the response proportionate? Are we responding to facts or wounded pride? Are we sacrificing tomorrow's institution for today's emotion?

This is why emotional intelligence, valuable as it is, is not enough. Emotional governance is indispensable. Leadership requires structures and habits that prevent personal feelings from travelling unchecked through institutional power.

Shurpanakha's story also contains an important final irony. When she later confronts Ravana, she criticises his failures as a ruler, including his lack of vigilance and self-restraint. The person whose own emotions contributed to escalation is still capable of recognising failures in another. Wisdom should be judged by its truth, not merely by its messenger. Difficult employees can identify real weaknesses. Imperfect colleagues can deliver necessary warnings. Mature leaders listen without allowing personality or past conflict to determine whether an argument deserves consideration.

Ultimately, the story is not only about Shurpanakha. It is about a chain of choices in which each response creates either an opportunity for restraint or another reason for escalation. Shurpanakha's conduct reminds us to respect boundaries and accept rejection without treating it as humiliation. Rama and Lakshmana's encounter with her invites reflection on how boundaries are communicated and enforced. Khara demonstrates the danger of retaliation without sufficient inquiry. Ravana reveals the catastrophic consequences of allowing family grievance and personal desire to shape the exercise of power.

For individuals, the lesson is self-mastery. For leaders, it is proportionality, dignity and judgement. For institutions, it is the ability to hear grievances fairly, protect the complainant, examine every side and prevent emotion from becoming policy. Conflict is inevitable. Escalation is not. Perhaps the real measure of leadership is not whether conflict enters our lives, but whether it becomes larger after passing through our hands.

Power may determine how far our decisions travel, but character determines the direction in which they go.

Views expressed are personal

Faster Lives: When Convenience kills Civic Sense

Technology saves time, yet constant convenience has made us increasingly intolerant of delays; writes Ritik Kumar

India's digital revolution has made inconvenience increasingly optional. Money moves in seconds. Groceries arrive before a pot of rice can cook. Dinner can be summoned with a few taps. A forgotten charger, a packet of milk or even a single chocolate can appear at the doorstep almost immediately. These are extraordinary improvements in everyday life. But somewhere between the QR code and the ten-minute delivery promise, convenience has begun changing not merely how urban India consumes, but how it behaves.

The problem is not technology. UPI has democratised payments, delivery platforms have created new forms of employment, and quick commerce has solved genuine urban problems. The concern is what happens when speed stops being a service and becomes an expectation. Once ten-minute delivery becomes normal, twelve minutes begins to feel like failure. Once a cab can be tracked to the metre, waiting three minutes feels unreasonable. Once a restaurant meal can be ordered without speaking to another human being, the person carrying it can easily become an icon moving across a screen rather than a worker navigating traffic, rain and heat.

This is where convenience begins colliding with civic sense. The modern consumer has acquired unprecedented visibility over service workers without necessarily acquiring greater empathy for them. We can watch a delivery rider's progress, call repeatedly when the map appears stationary, complain instantly and rate performance in seconds. The worker, meanwhile, operates inside a system in which delays may affect incentives, ratings and future earnings. A traffic jam, security check at a housing complex or crowded restaurant kitchen becomes his problem because the customer's clock continues ticking.

There is an uncomfortable irony here. Technology was supposed to save human time; instead, having our time saved constantly appears to have made us more intolerant of losing even a little of it. The consequences extend beyond delivery platforms. Digital payments have made transactions frictionless, but impatience surfaces when a QR code fails. App-based transport has made mobility easier, yet a cancelled ride can trigger disproportionate rage. Housing societies demand doorstep convenience while sometimes treating delivery personnel as security risks rather than people doing their jobs. The language itself is revealing: we increasingly speak of "orders", "partners", "ratings" and "ETA", reducing human interactions to transactions and metrics.

WHEN EVERY MINUTE
MATTERS, EMPATHY
CAN BECOME
COLLATERAL DAMAGE

None of this requires romanticising the age of queues, cash shortages or trips to distant markets. Convenience is progress, and India should want more of it. But technological progress does not automatically produce social progress. A sophisticated digital economy can coexist with an increasingly impatient society.

The answer is not slower commerce. It is better behaviour. Consumers can demand reliable services without demanding impossible perfection. Companies can compete on convenience without constructing business models that transfer every second of pressure to workers. And cities can embrace instant services while remembering that the person ringing the doorbell is not the final component of an algorithm.

Perhaps the real test of a technologically advanced society is not how quickly it can deliver a packet of groceries. It is whether, after making everything faster, it can still find a few seconds for patience.

Views expressed are personal

Briefs

DRI seizes Meth worth Rs 300-cr

MUMBAI: The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) has seized 55 kg of methamphetamine worth around Rs 300 crore from a maize consignment at a Container Freight Station near Nhava Sheva port here, officials said. The consignment was allegedly linked to a Pakistan-based narco-trafficking syndicate led by Moham-mad Hussain Dad. Two people have been detained and further investigation into the seizure is underway.

THDC tunnel mishap toll rises to nine

DEHRADUN: The body of a worker trapped when water flooded into a tunnel five days ago was found on Tuesday, taking the death toll to nine. Another worker remains missing, officials said. Twenty-two people were caught in the three-kilometre tunnel, part of the THDC's Vishnugad-Pipalkoti hydroelectric project in Chamoli, when a landslide led to debris and water flooding in on August 13.

Guj: CISF recovers flyer's bag

AHMEDABAD: CISF personnel at Ahmedabad airport recovered a passenger's trolley bag containing Rs 2.97 lakh in cash and several valuables after a woman left it near the Terminal-1 exit while collecting baggage. The bag, found during routine patrol, was screened by the bomb detection squad and later handed back to the passenger after verification and requisite formalities.

Bribery case: DGMS officer held

NEW DELHI: The CBI has arrested a Deputy Director (Mining) of the Directorate General of Mines Safety, Hyderabad-III Region, South Central Zone, and two others in an alleged Rs 2 lakh bribery case linked to a fatal mine accident inquiry in Andhra Pradesh. The officer was allegedly caught accepting the bribe in Ongole on Monday for preparing a favourable accident report.

NCB busts int'l drug ring, 4 held

NEW DELHI: The NCB has busted an international drug-trafficking network allegedly run by foreign nationals illegally staying in India and arrested four Nigerians. The agency recovered 14.787 kg amphetamine, 67.84 kg pseudoephedrine, 318 grams cocaine and six grams heroin, collectively valued at around Rs 15 crore. The NCB said further investigation is underway to trace the network's linkages.

‘TRUST-BASED ENGAGEMENTS ON EXPORT CONTROLS NEEDED’

India and US must address ‘friction points’, says Ambassador Sergio Gor

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, August 18

US Ambassador Sergio Gor on Tuesday said India and the US must address friction points as true partners and work on predictable taxation and regulatory frameworks to allow business to thrive.

Speaking at the Indo-American Chamber of Commerce here, Gor stressed the need for candid, trust-based engagements on export controls and rock-solid intellectual property protections to give innovators confidence to invest, create and scale without fear.

The Indo-American Chamber of Commerce (IACC) held its national convention, themed Re-defining the India-US Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.

Gor said that the US embassy in India topped the list among US embassies worldwide in attracting over USD 20 billion in investment.

When Indian companies invest in America, it is a win-win situation. They get access to one of the world's most dynamic markets, he said.

“This relationship has unbelievable and incredible potential. To unleash the full power of the economic engine, we must address friction points together as true partners. We need predictable tax-



Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis with US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor during the IACC National Convention, in Mumbai, Tuesday

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Gor was speaking at the national convention of the Indo-American Chamber of Commerce in Mumbai
- » The Ambassador stressed the need for candid, trust-based engagements on export controls
- » The theme of the IACC national convention was ‘Re-defining the India-US Comprehensive Strategic Partnership’

tion and regulatory frameworks that allow business to thrive,” he said.

The US ambassador, however, did not touch upon tariffs and visas, which have been India's major concerns.

The US envoy said when

companies around the world tell him that their intellectual property rights have been stolen and they want to move their firms to India, they ask whether it is safe here and his answer is a resounding yes.

“We do trust India,” he

said, adding that President Donald Trump has trusted India and invested heavily in this relationship from day one.

He noted that in just over two decades, bilateral trade between India and the US has shattered records, skyrocketing from USD 20 billion to USD 240 billion in goods and services.

The 12-fold increase doesn't happen by accident, he said, asserting that the two countries share the ambition of taking this figure to USD 500 billion by 2030, which reflects the sheer scale of unmatched

potential.

“When India and the US work together, they integrate value chains, accelerate breakthroughs in critical technologies and strengthen supply chain resilience,” Gor said.

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, who was also at the event, said that technology will be the strongest part of the Indo-US relationship going forward.

Technology is changing the meaning of economic partnership, he said.

Fadnavis said that artificial intelligence, semiconductors, quantum technologies, cybersecurity, cloud and data infrastructure, advanced manufacturing, medical technology, bio-technology and dual-use technologies constitute the core infrastructure of economic power in the next decade. And Maharashtra wants to participate in the entire spectrum.

“India has extraordinary engineering and scientific talent. The US has extraordinary capabilities in frontier research, technologies, capital and global enterprise. The next phase of cooperation between the two nations should be about joint innovation platforms, joint research, technology transfer, global capability centres, manufacturing partnerships and new global supply chains,” the chief minister said.

CJP urges Centre to honour its promises

Group seeks withdrawal of FIRs

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Tuesday urged the Centre to honour its commitments made after the July student agitation, pressing for the withdrawal of FIRs against protesters and seeking representation on the Supreme Court's proposed high-powered committee that will examine allegations of police excesses and violence during the July 20 protests around Jantar Mantar.

Addressing the media outside the Supreme Court, CJP chief spokesperson Saurav Das said that “the bench repeatedly asked the Centre during the hearing to furnish a list of FIRs registered against protesters so that the court could consider quashing appropriate cases.” He alleged that “despite earlier assurances, the government had not committed before the court to submitting such a list.”

According to Das, senior advocate Vrinda Grover, appearing for the petitioners, requested the apex court to invoke Article 142 of the Constitution to quash FIRs filed against peaceful protesters across the country. He argued that the Centre had earlier accepted the protesters' demands when the agitation ended on July 25.

Das also claimed that assurances relating to compensation and follow-up meetings with CJP representatives had not been fulfilled.

THE CJP ALSO SOUGHT REPRESENTATION ON SC-PROPOSED PANEL

He said the party's National Working Committee would decide its future course of action if the government failed to implement the agreed measures.

CJP legal affairs head Ratna Singh said the organisation had shared a legally vetted draft with the government after their last meeting on August 2 but had received no response. She also sought inclusion of CJP representatives in the high-powered committee, saying the panel should function independently.

The Supreme Court announced that it would constitute a committee comprising retired judges, a former Director General of Police and a former CBI director to examine allegations of police excesses, violence against police personnel, sexual assault claims and online harassment of women protesters. The court also said CCTV footage and video recordings of the July 20 protests would be handed over to the panel for examination.

Das questioned the use of facial recognition technology during the protests, calling for judicial scrutiny of its constitutional validity. Meanwhile, CJP co-convenor Ashutosh Ranka alleged that the party's Kolkata meeting had been cancelled after venue operators came under political pressure.

CM plans to prune HP's bureaucracy

ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, August 18

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu has decided to seek a reduction in the sanctioned strength of IAS, IPS and IFS officers, citing the growing financial burden of maintaining a large bureaucracy in the financially stressed hill state.

Sukhu said the state would approach the Centre to reduce its IAS cadre strength by 23 posts, from 153 to 130.

The IFS cadre would be reduced by 35 posts, from 118 to 83, while the sanctioned strength of the 96-member IPS cadre would also be downsized.

The Chief Minister said the state spends nearly Rs 200 crore on maintaining the large cadre, including salaries, vehicles, staff, accommodation, medical expenses and travel.

“Himachal will seek a reduction of 23 IAS posts, bringing the sanctioned strength down from 153 to 130, and similarly, the IFS cadre strength is to be reduced from 118 to 83, that is by 35 posts, and as far as the IPS cadre, which is presently having 96 posts, it also needs to be downsized,” Sukhu said.

He said the state did not need a large bureaucracy, claiming several officers did not have enough work and their capabilities remained underutilised.

Sukhu said the government was now issuing no-objection certificates and relieving officers for central deputation without delays, unlike in the past.

The move comes amid Himachal's worsening fiscal position. The state has suffered a Rs 10,000 crore annual reduction in Revenue Deficit Grant, while its debt burden has crossed Rs 1 lakh crore.

Jharkhand exam stir: Devendra Mahto, 2 protesters end fast after govt cancels tests

MPOST BUREAU
Ranchi, August 18

JLKM leader Devendra Mahto and two other protesters ended their hunger strike after the Jharkhand government cancelled the JSSC-CGL examination and all recruitment tests conducted by an outsourced agency since 2014, but the agitation for reforms and a probe into alleged irregularities is set to continue.

Mahto, who had been on a hunger strike for 16 days, called off his fast around Monday midnight. Prem Nayak and Umme Habiba also ended their fast, while three other protesters – Rahul Kranti, Sabita Kumari and Rupesh Pal – are continuing with the hunger strike.

The JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch has been spearheading the agitation at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium since July 25. The protest entered its 25th day.

Mahto said he had ended his hunger strike,



Students during a hunger strike over the alleged exam irregularities, in Ranchi, Tuesday

of our protest, demanding corruption-free recruitment in JPSC and JSSC examinations,” Mahto told reporters.

The second phase will be launched under the banner of the JPSC-JSSC Abhiyarthi Reform Manch, headed by Mahto.

Chief Minister Hemant Soren, after chairing a marathon cabinet meeting on Monday, announced the cancellation of the JSSC-CGL examination and all tests conducted by TSR Data Processing Pvt Ltd (TDPL), along with the

results published by the agency. The government has also constituted an exam reforms committee headed by senior IAS officer Amitabh Kaushal to recommend measures to strengthen the recruitment process.

Mahto demanded a monitoring committee and a complete audit of the recruitment examination process, saying it should cover every stage and not be limited to financial aspects.

The protesters, however, maintained that their demand for a CBI probe into alleged examination irregularities had not been accepted. Rahul Kranti said the agitation would continue until the government agreed to the demand.

Meanwhile, successful JSSC-CGL candidates staged a counter-protest, urging Soren not to cancel the examination. They claimed the decision could render around 2,000 people jobless.

‘Western Himalaya warming faster than other stretches’

Night-time temperatures climbing faster than daytime highs over western Himalaya, claims study

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 18

The western Himalaya, spanning across Ladakh, Jammu and Kashmir and Himachal Pradesh, is warming faster than the central and eastern stretches of the range, according to a new study.

It added that winter is warming faster than spring, and night-time temperatures are climbing faster than daytime highs over the western Himalaya.

The study, ‘Vulnerability of the Himalayan region under the climate change’, was published in the Jour-

KEY POINTS

- » The study, ‘Vulnerability of the Himalayan region under the climate change’, was published in the Journal of Earth System Science
- » It revealed that across the Himalaya, more snow is lost in spring than in winter, and by far the most is lost in the west
- » ‘The western Himalaya consistently emerges as the most sensitive stretch — it warms the most and loses the most snow under every pathway tested’



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

nal of Earth System Science and made public on Monday.

It was led by the Department of Remote Sensing

and Geoinformatics, Birla Institute of Technology (BIT), Ranchi, with the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune,

and Ashoka University.

The authors of the analysis used two kinds of evidence.

The first is a 120-year

record of actual temperature measurements across the region, running from 1901 to 2020.

The second is a set of eight global climate models, first checked against what has already happened and then run forward to 2,100 under five possible futures -- from a world that cuts emissions sharply to one that keeps burning fossil fuels at the current pace

The study also revealed that across the Himalaya, more snow is lost in spring than in winter, and by far the most is lost in the west.

It highlighted that springtime snow loss over

News at a glance

Blast from old munitions injures 6 in northern Israel

BANGKOK: An explosion of old munitions in northern Israel on Tuesday injured six Thai migrant workers, with two sustaining serious injuries that required surgery, Thailand's Foreign Ministry said.

There are more than 40,000 Thai workers in Israel, mostly in the agricultural sector. Most are from rural areas where employment prospects are poor, so they work abroad to send money back to their families. Israeli media reported that the workers were hurt when unexploded ordnance detonated in an orchard near the town of Metula.

'Grenade attack near school in Kabul wounds children'

KABUL: A hand grenade attack near a school in the Afghan capital Kabul on Monday afternoon wounded multiple children, authorities said.

Kabul police spokesman Khalid Zadran said late Monday that "a number of children" had been wounded, and said an investigation was underway. He did not provide further details.

Richard Bennett, the United Nations' special rapporteur for Afghanistan, on Tuesday condemned "the heinous attack harming numerous children near a school" the previous day.

China's former premier Zhu Rongji cremated in Beijing

BEIJING: China's former premier Zhu Rongji, who passed away at the age of 98 last week, was cremated in Beijing on Tuesday.

President Xi Jinping and other senior leaders of the ruling Communist Party of China (CPC) attended the funeral held at the Babaoshan Revolutionary Cemetery.

The leaders walked slowly toward Zhu's body amid solemn music and stood in silent tribute. Former president Hu Jintao sent a wreath to express his condolences over Zhu's passing.



A man walks past a mosque collapsed during an earthquake in Indonesia, on Tuesday

AP/PTI

SL presents bill to extend retirement age of judges

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Colombo, August 18

Sri Lanka's government on Tuesday presented a constitutional amendment bill to extend the retirement age of judges, despite strong opposition from various political parties and the country's bar association.

Minister of Justice and National Integration Harshana Nanayakkara presented the 22nd Amendment to the Constitution Bill, that seeks to extend the retirement age of Supreme Court judges from 65 to 67 and the Court of Appeal judges from 63 to 65.

The minister also presented the Judicature (Amendment) Bill, which includes amendments to extend the retirement age of judges in other courts.

The government argued that extending judges' terms was a necessity to clear the current backlog of over 1.1 million cases.

TEHRAN SAYS STRAIT OF HORMUZ STILL SHUT
No talks planned with Iran: Trump

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, August 18

US President Donald Trump said Tuesday the U.S. has no talks planned with Iran but insisted the Strait of Hormuz remains "open and operating," despite limited traffic and a reported strike on a ship exiting the waterway.

Earlier this week, Trump also threatened to bomb Oman as the country sought a deal with Iran to manage shipping traffic through the strait, two regional officials said Tuesday, a day after Trump leveled the threat.

Iran says the waterway will not be reopened until the U.S. meets its conditions.

As talks between Iran and Oman continue, a projectile hit a ship in the strait and Iran-backed Houthi rebels claimed they fired drones at an oil refinery in Saudi Arabia.

As Oman and Iran say they are nearing a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, Trump said on social media Tuesday that the U.S. blockade of Iranian ports remains "in full force and effect," and asserted that all water mines have been removed.



Representational Image

KEY POINTS

- » Egypt says Iran-Oman agreement could open door to Iran-US deal
- » Ship traffic drops significantly in Strait of Hormuz
- » Projectile damages ship in strait causing casualty

Trump posted a map depicting the strait as U.S. territory. Iranian Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi appeared to respond to Trump's post.

"Just as Trump correctly wrote the name of the eternal Persian Gulf, soon his delusion regard-

ing the Strait of Hormuz will either be corrected or we will correct the delusions of this deluded man," he wrote on X.

The Trump administration has told Oman it opposes parts of the yet-to-be-announced deal, according to officials briefed on the U.S. position. Those include joint Iranian and Omani management of the passage's

exit route and the collection of voluntary fees from vessels, even if the money is used for security and maritime environmental protection. The officials spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to talk to journalists.

The White House on Tuesday referred to Trump's remarks in the Oval Office and declined to comment further about Oman.

By Samy Magdy in Cairo The Egyptian Foreign Ministry said Tuesday that the Iranian-Omani deal could pave the way for Washington and Tehran to return to negotiations for a "comprehensive and permanent deal that addresses all concerns and enhances regional security and stability."

The statement came after a meeting between Egyptian Foreign Minister Badr Abdelatty and Omani counterpart Badr al-Busaidi. But it did not address Trump's latest threat against Oman.

The 60-day negotiating period ended this week between the U.S. and Iran with no clear end to the war in sight.

Russian missiles kill 10 in Ukrainian village

Kyiv aims a drone blitz at Moscow



ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, August 18

Ukrainian forces staged one of their biggest drone attacks on Russia since Moscow's invasion more than four years ago, firing almost 800 drones just two days after launching a similar salvo, officials said Tuesday.

Meanwhile, a Russian missile strike on a village in Ukraine's north-eastern Kharkiv region killed at least 10 people and wounded eight others as the barrage demolished homes, officials said Tuesday.

The warring countries are locked in an escalating duel of long-range aerial strikes. Fighting on the roughly 1,250-kilometre (780-mile) front line

THE WARRING COUNTRIES ARE LOCKED IN AN ESCALATING DUEL OF LONG-RANGE AERIAL STRIKES

in eastern and southern Ukraine is restricted by large numbers of drones and ground robots threatening troop movements, and neither side is making significant battlefield progress, analysts say.

Over the past year Ukraine has devised and deployed domestically produced long-range drones for strikes deep inside Russia. Its drone technology has impressed governments and defence manufacturers around the world.

Philippine student kills schoolmate and himself in livestreamed attack

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Manila, August 18

A high school student carrying two pistols shot to death a fellow student before killing himself Tuesday in an attack in a southern Philippine high school campus that he livestreamed using a body-worn camera, police and other officials

said.mlt was the second fatal school shooting in the country in just two months.

Hundreds of students were evacuated after shots rang out in the high school building of the Ateneo de Zamboanga university campus in the southern port city of Zamboanga. Two other people were injured, police and city

officials said.

The suspect, identified by police as grade 9 student Mohammad Mael Jalani, fired at a teacher sitting in front of a class but apparently missed. He then shot a student on the fourth floor of the building before going up one floor and killing himself, police said in an initial report.

N Korea grows stronger as South reckons with fading US support

North Korea has gained a lot from its ties with Russiaa

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Birmingham, August 18

According to Ukraine's president, Volodymyr Zelenskyy, North Korea is preparing to send as many as 50,000 fresh troops to support Russia's military campaign in Ukraine. While the South Korean Ministry of Foreign Affairs has been unable to verify Zelenskyy's claim, it has not fallen on deaf ears in Seoul.

When questioned on August 10, an unnamed foreign-ministry spokesperson stated: North Korea-Russia military cooperation is a matter directly related to our security and an act that violates UN Security Council resolutions ... the government's posi-



tion is that such cooperation must be suspended immediately, and we are closely monitoring related developments.

Any new deployment would continue to cement a clear path. Pyongyang and Moscow signed a mutual defence pact in June 2024 and, within months, up to 15,000 North Korean personnel had been deployed to

Russia. The deployment ranged from construction workers to logistics personnel, missile operators, engineers and infantry. It included 1,500 special forces troops.

North Korea has gained a lot from its partnership with Russia. So far, its troops have not fought within Ukraine's internationally recognised borders.

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001: 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Telibandha, Raipur (C.G.) – 492006
CIN: U45203CT1981SG001853; PAN: AABCM6288N, GST Regn. No. 22AABCM6288NSZY
Phone: 0771-6621000, Fax: 0771-2583794
Website: www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc.cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (1st Call)
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

NIT No. 25 /CSIDC/E.E./Division-I/2026-27/ 197787 Raipur, Dated 17/08/2026

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender for the following work :-

S.No.	Name of Work	Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't.	Probable Amount of Contract (PAC) (INR Crore)	Last Date for Submission of tender
A	Infrastructure development works i/c roads, drainage, culverts, water supply system & street light for Proposed New Industrial Area at Village- Anjani, District- Gaurela-pendra-Marwahi (C.G.)	Class-B & Above	3.07	09/09/2026

The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of works and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 17/08/2026 Time 17:01 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk. Operated by **Mjunction Services Limited**, they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in

Executive Engineer
Division-I
samvud 48792/3

Executive Engineer Office, P. W. Division No. 1, Thane Parking Plaza Building 8th Floor, Service Road, Off Eastern Express Highway, Near Jupiter Hospital, Thane - 400601.

☎ - thane1.ee@mahapwd.gov.in ☎ - 24999999

No./TD/Tender/ 7 833 Date: 17/08/2026

E-Tender Corrigendum No.1 (Time Table)

WORK NAME :- E-Tender No. 29/01 Year 2025-26
Repair Renovation of Integrated Child Development Service Scheme, Maharashtra State, Belapur, Navi Mumbai (Women and Child Development Department, Maharashtra State).
Ref :- Estimated Cost :- 1,96,20,122.00
E-Tender Notice No. 29 Year 2024-25 Letter Dated No. This Office Letter No. Tender/7627 Date: 06/08/2026.

Sr.No	Tender	Before Publish Date	Now Publish Date
1	Selling Date	13.08.2026 TO 24.08.2026	13.08.2026 TO 27.08.2026
2	Pre-bid Mitting	17.08.2026	21.08.2026
3	Tender Opening Date	25.08.2026	28.08.2026

DGIPR/2026/27/2367 Executive Engineer, P.W. Division No.1, Thane

Government of India
Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship

Notice Inviting Request for Proposal (RFP)
Tender Ref No: RDSDE/NSTI-Hyderabad/79621
Tender ID: 2026_DGT_920994_1

Request for Proposal for Selection of Lead Industry Partner (LIP) for Capacity Augmentation of National Skill Training Institute (NSTI) and Setting up of National Centre of Excellence (NCoE) located at Hyderabad under PM-SETU

The Regional Directorate of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship (RDSDE), Telangana invites online applications from eligible organizations for Selection of Lead Industry Partner (LIP) for Capacity Augmentation of National Skill Training Institute and Setting up of National Centre of Excellence (NCoE) located at Hyderabad under Component II of the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) through <https://eprocure.gov.in>. The RFP document is also available on <https://pm-setu.skillindia.digital.gov.in>. The last date & time for submission of online applications is 07.09.2026 up to 03:30 PM.

Regional Director
Regional Directorate Skill Development & Entrepreneurship, Telangana
cbc 63101/11/0010/2627 DGT, MSDE, Government of India

Government of India
Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship

Notice Inviting Request for Proposal (RFP)
Tender Ref No: NSTICHN/TN/ PMSETU-II/2026
Tender ID: 2026_DGT_921280_1

Request for Proposal for Selection of Lead Industry Partner (LIP) for Capacity Augmentation of National Skill Training Institute (NSTI) and Setting up of National Centre of Excellence (NCoE) located at Chennai under PM-SETU

The Regional Directorate of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship (RDSDE), Tamilnadu invites online applications from eligible organizations for Selection of Lead Industry Partner (LIP) for Capacity Augmentation of National Skill Training Institute and Setting up of National Centre of Excellence (NCoE) located at Chennai under Component II of the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) through <https://eprocure.gov.in>. The RFP document is also available on <https://pm-setuskillindia.digital.gov.in>. The last date & time for submission of online applications is 25.09.2026 up to 06:00 PM.

Regional Director
Regional Directorate Skill Development & Entrepreneurship, Tamilnadu
DGT, MSDE, Government of India cbc 63101/11/0011/2627

News at a glance

Rupee falls 13 paise to close at 95.74 against US dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 13 paise to close at 95.74 against the US dollar on Tuesday, weighed down by elevated crude oil prices and lingering geo-political tensions in West Asia.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.68 against the greenback and traded in a range of 95.64-95.69 during the session. It eventually settled at 95.74, lower by 13 paise from its previous close. Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 99.60, down 0.04 per cent.

ICICI Bank raises \$750 mn via bonds from overseas mkts

NEW DELHI: ICICI Bank on Tuesday said it has raised \$750 million through bonds from the overseas market to support business growth. The bonds were issued through the bank's IFSC banking unit at a coupon rate of 5.417 per cent. The five-year senior unsecured fixed-rate notes are part of ICICI Bank's \$7.5 billion Global Medium Term Note Programme.

The net proceeds from the issue will be used for general corporate purposes in accordance with applicable regulatory guidelines, the bank said in a regulatory filing.

India seeks consultations with US over quartz duties

NEW DELHI India has sought consultations with the US under the WTO Agreement on Safeguards over tariffs imposed on quartz surface products.

The US on July 31 introduced a tariff-rate quota on imports of these products from several countries. Effective August 15, the measure imposes duties of up to 50 per cent on shipments exceeding specified quotas. India, citing its substantial interest, requested consultations with the US, a WTO communication said. India proposed holding the talks virtually at a mutually convenient time.

Gold surges to ₹1.58 lakh per 10 gram, silver jumps by ₹730

NEW DELHI: Gold price climbed Rs 2,000 to Rs 1.58 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday, extending gains for a second straight session as retailers and stockists stepped up buying.

The yellow metal of 999 per cent purity appreciated by Rs 2,000 to Rs 1,58,800 per 10 grams from Monday's closing level of Rs 1,56,800 per 10 grams. Silver also advanced Rs 730 to Rs 2,40,730 per kilogram, after remaining flat at Rs 2,40,000 per kg for two sessions, according to the All India Sarafa Association.

ROUNDTABLE WITH GLOBAL CEOs ON AGENDA

PM Modi to inaugurate SEMICON India's 5th edition on September 17

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate, on September 17, the fifth edition of SEMICON India 2026, a mega-event that is set to bring together global semiconductor industry leaders, government officials, state representatives, and sector experts as India looks to build on the momentum of its growing semiconductor ecosystem.

The three-day event, to be held from September 17-19 in New Delhi, is being organised under the theme 'Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem'.

"The event is proposed to be inaugurated by the PM on September 17, and we believe it will once again reiterate the commitment that the government has for the semiconductor sector," IT Secretary S Krishnan said.

The event comes at a time when India's semiconductor push is gaining pace under the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) and the Semicon India programme. "The confer-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi

ence will have a roundtable which will be chaired by the PM, and that will take place a day before September 17, with global CEOs," Amitesh Kumar Sinha, Additional Secretary, IT Ministry and CEO, ISM, said at a curtain-raiser briefing.

The prominent global CEOs who are expected at the event has not yet been disclosed. The event is also expected to see participation of countries including Japan, Korea, Singapore, Germany and the Netherlands. The US, which has led international efforts on 'Pax Silica' for resilient supply chains in semicon-

ductors, AI and critical minerals, is also expected to be present at the event.

Earlier this year, during the AI Impact Summit in February, India formally joined the 'Pax Silica' coalition, marking a significant milestone in the strengthening of strategic technology and supply chain cooperation between New Delhi and Washington.

It is pertinent to mention that while 12 projects have been approved under Semicon 1.0 -- three of which have already started commercial production and 2-3 more are expected to follow suit by the calendar

KEY POINTS

- » The three-day event, to be held from September 17-19 in New Delhi, is being organised under the theme 'Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem'
- » The US, which has led international efforts on 'Pax Silica' for resilient supply chains in semiconductors, AI and critical minerals, is also expected to be present at the event

tic semiconductor ecosystem in India and advancing the government's Atmanirbhar Bharat vision, it said.

The details of SEMICON India 2026 were announced by ISM, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) and SEMI, the industry association promoting the semiconductor sector, at a press conference.

The event will bring together stakeholders from across the global semiconductor ecosystem, including industry leaders, government representatives, experts, academia and students, as per the release.

SEMICON India 2026 is expected to showcase developments across the semiconductor value chain as India seeks to cement its position in the global chip ecosystem.

Ashok Chandak, President, SEMI India & IESA, noted that SEMICON India's 2026 theme 'Silicon to Systems' reflects the nation's evolution towards creating a comprehensive and globally-competitive semiconductor value chain.

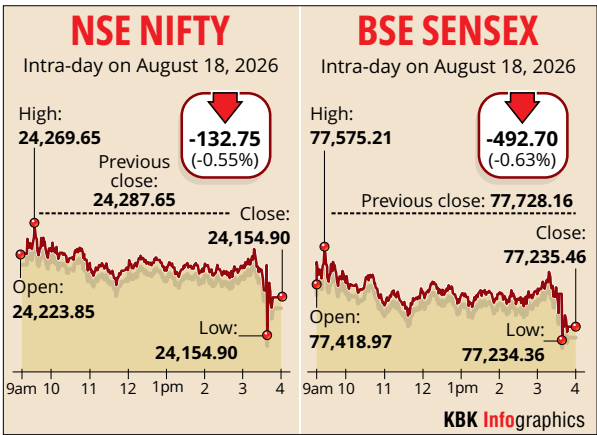
Markets tumble as crude oil prices jump to \$91 per barrel

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 18

Market benchmark indices ended lower on Tuesday, with the Sensex falling 493 points and the Nifty dropping to 24,154.90 level, amid elevated crude oil prices and fading hopes of a diplomatic breakthrough in West Asia tensions.

The 30-share BSE Sensex was down 492.70 points, or 0.63 per cent, to settle at 77,235.46, registering its third day of decline. The 50-share NSE Nifty declined for the sixth day, sliding 132.75 points, or 0.55 per cent, to end at 24,154.90.

From the Sensex pack,



Asian Paints, Infosys, HCL Tech, Bharti Airtel, TCS, and Hindustan Unilever were among the major laggards. Axis Bank, Power Grid, Mahindra & Mahin-

dra, and Bajaj Finance were among the winners.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, went up 0.17 per cent to \$91.02/barrel.

HZL hikes renewable power use to 22%

MPOST BUREAU
Udaipur, August 18

Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL), the world's largest integrated zinc producer, has increased the share of renewable power in its overall electricity consumption to 22 per cent, from around 18 per cent in FY26.

The company aims to meet around 70 per cent of its power requirements through renewable energy by FY28.

During FY26, HZL generated 892 million units of green power, up from 632 million units in FY25.

To support its clean energy target, the company expanded its round-

the-clock renewable power delivery agreement with Serentica Renewables to 530 MW from 450 MW. It is also upgrading power connectivity and implementing projects such as waste heat recovery improvements and floating solar installations.

HZL said its renewable energy portfolio combines solar, wind and energy storage solutions to provide reliable clean power across its operations.

The initiatives are part of the company's broader decarbonisation strategy and its Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi)-validated pathway towards achieving net-zero emissions by 2050 or sooner.

BPCL develops Satna as district-level CBG ecosystem

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 18

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) has established Satna as a district-level gas ecosystem, where energy requirements of PNG domestic and commercial consumers, as well as CNG-powered vehicles, are being met through Compressed Biogas (CBG) produced from waste.

The initiative is part of BPCL's #TheGoodPrint Solution for the nation, a decentralised model aimed at converting locally available waste into clean



energy and using it within the same ecosystem.

In Satna, waste generated in and around the district is processed to produce biogas, which is upgraded into CBG and supplied through existing gas distribution infrastructure. This creates an integrated value chain connecting waste generation,

CBG production, distribution and end-use within the same geography.

The model demonstrates CBG's potential beyond its conventional use as a transport fuel. Locally produced renewable gas is being supplied to PNG domestic and commercial consumers and used by CNG-powered automobiles.

BPCL is also strengthening the CBG value chain through partnerships with producers across the country to build a reliable supply base and integrate renewable gas into its City Gas Distribution network.

NHAI extends digital FASTag local pass facility to 121 toll plazas

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 18

The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has extended its online FASTag 'Local Pass' facility to 121 toll plazas across the country, the Ministry of Road Transport & Highways said on Tuesday.

Eligible commuters can apply for the monthly pass through the Rajmargyatra mobile app, eliminating physical visits and manual submission of documents.

Under the facility, residents within a 20-km radius of eligible toll plazas can apply for unlimited travel during the month, subject to applicable rules.

The digital facility uses consent-based integration with platforms such as DigiLocker and VAHAN to verify residential address, vehicle details and FASTag information.

GIS-based verification is also used to establish eligibility based on the applicant's registered address.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

Under the CSR initiative of REC Ltd, Governor of Chhattisgarh, Ramen Deka, flagged off six Mobile Medical Units (MMUs), worth Rs 7.21 crore, at Lok Bhawan, Chhattisgarh, on August 15, 2026, in the presence of Satyaban Sahoo, Chief Project Manager, Regional Office Raipur, REC Ltd, along with officials from REC Ltd and the Indian Red Cross Society (IRCS), Chhattisgarh.

POWERGRID celebrated the 80th Independence Day with patriotic fervour and enthusiasm at its more than 200 establishments and offices across the country. At the Corporate Centre, Gurugram, Vamsi Rama Mohan Burra, Chairman & MD, POWERGRID, hoisted the National Flag in the presence of Dr. Yatindra Dwivedi, Director (Personnel), Naveen Srivastava, Director (Operations).

Amol Taori takes charge as Director (Finance) at POWERGRID

MPOST BUREAU
Udaipur, August 18

Amol Taori has assumed charge as Director (Finance) of POWERGRID, effective August 18, 2026. A CA with nearly 30 years of experience, Taori has worked across finance, treasury, international trade, marketing and compensation management. Before joining POWERGRID, he served as Executive Director (In-charge) - International Trade at Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd



(HPCL), overseeing crude procurement, product imports and exports, shipping and oil price risk management. During his career, Taori managed HPCL's corporate treasury for over a decade and spearheaded its maiden USD bond issue.

News at a glance

Paytm block deal draws key buyers like Goldman Sachs

NEW DELHI: Foreign and domestic institutional investors, including Goldman Sachs, BNP Paribas and Societe Generale, on Tuesday bought a 3 per cent stake in Paytm parent One97 Communications for Rs 2,949 crore through block deals.

Investors acquired 1,92,10,110 shares at an average price of Rs 1,535.10 apiece, as per the NSE data. Domestic participants included SBI MF, HDFC MF, Kotak Mahindra MF and Tata MF, while ICICI Prudential Life Insurance and Tata AIA Life Insurance also bought shares. Resilient Asset Management BV sold an equal number of shares at the same price.

ReNew net profit rises 16% to ₹595.3 cr in April-June qtr

NEW DELHI: ReNew Energy Global Plc (ReNew) on Tuesday posted a 16 per cent year-on-year rise in its net profit to Rs 595.3 crore in the April-June quarter of FY27, citing higher revenues. "Net profit for Q1 FY27 was Rs 5,953 million, against Rs 5,131 million (Rs 513.1 crore) for Q1 FY26," the company said.

Total income or revenue for Q1 FY27 was at Rs 47,864 million (Rs 4,786.4 crore), against Rs 41,182 million (Rs 4,118.2 crore) for Q1 FY26. Revenue from the sale of power for Q1 FY27 was Rs 26,749 million (Rs 2,674.9 crore), compared to Rs 25,473 million (Rs 2,547.3 crore) for Q1 FY26.

Comm Min holds session on EU CBAM for exporters

NEW DELHI: The commerce ministry on Tuesday said it held an awareness session for exporters on the European Union Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (EU CBAM).

The session covered the CBAM framework, applicability, covered products, exporter obligations, calculation of embedded emissions, data collection and reporting, and accreditation and verification mechanisms.

Practical case studies from the iron and steel and aluminium sectors were also discussed to help exporters understand the requirements.

Uzbekistan seeks Indian steel imports to cut logistics costs

NEW DELHI: Uzbekistan is keen to import steel from India to lower logistics costs, an industry official said on Tuesday. The landlocked country imports around 1 million tonnes of steel, including TMT bars, from China, with logistics costs via sea routes reaching \$100 per tonne.

Uzbekistan is exploring a shorter alternative route from India, which could reduce costs. The Uzbekistan Metallurgy Association has signed an MoU with the Indian Steel Association (ISA) to promote cooperation in manufacturing, technology, environment, sustainability and logistics.

THE EXERCISE HAS COVERED APPROXIMATELY 394 ENTITIES

I-T department launches drive to verify ‘suspicious’ foreign remittances

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 18

The income tax department has launched a drive to verify “suspicious” foreign remittances by entities with little or no reported business activity, the persons behind them and the CAs who issued tax determination certificates.

Entities located in districts along India’s land borders and remitting significant amounts of money abroad have also been covered in the exercise.

The exercise has covered approximately 394 entities (including 117 entities located in land-border states), and 36 professionals, the department said on X.

“On August 18, the Department launched a nationwide detailed verification exercise to verify these (suspicious) foreign remittances, focusing on shell entities, the persons behind them, and the professionals who have issued Form 15CB certificates,” the tax department said.

The verification of suspicious foreign remittances



I-T DEPT CAUTIONED CAs AGAINST ISSUING CERTIFICATES IN FORM 15CB/FORM 146 AND SAID THEY SHOULD EXERCISE DUE CARE, DILIGENCE AND PROFESSIONAL JUDGMENT

follows data analysis and ground intelligence indicating significant overseas remittances by entities with little or no reported business activity.

The Department cautioned CAs against issuing certificates in Form 15CB/ Form 146 and said they should exercise due care, diligence and professional judgment.

“They should properly

KEY POINTS

- » Preliminary ground verification revealed that the entities making these remittances were either non-filers or were filing income-tax returns showing very small turnovers
- » The turnovers had no apparent correlation with the large amounts of money being remitted abroad
- » ‘Further analysis of the data also revealed that a large number of Form 15CB certificates were issued by a relatively small group of professionals. The remitted funds were also received by a clustered group of entities,’ the I-T dept said

examine the underlying transactions and relevant facts before certifying the remittances, as these certifications play an important role in maintaining trust in the system,” the I-T department said in a statement.

Form 15CB or Form 146 is a tax determination certificate issued by CAs for foreign remittances from India. It is mandatory when

making taxable payments exceeding Rs 5 lakh in a financial year to a non-resident or foreign company, validating the tax deduction at source (TDS) & DTAA compliance.

Based on ground intelligence and analysis of data on outward foreign remittances, the I-T Department has identified several suspicious entities that remitted large amounts of forex over the last three years.

A nationwide network of entities engaged in remitting funds abroad was uncovered during a search operation conducted on a group of fictitious charitable trusts involved in providing accommodation entries against bogus donations/contributions, the tax department said.

Preliminary ground verification revealed that the entities making these remittances were either non-filers or were filing income-tax returns showing very small turnovers.

The turnovers had no apparent correlation with the large amounts of money being remitted abroad.

They also did not appear

to match the stated purpose of the remittances, such as payment for freight, import of software, or import of consulting services.

Further investigations revealed that these entities were not actually operating from the addresses declared by them.

“Further analysis of the data also revealed that a large number of Form 15CB certificates were issued by a relatively small group of professionals. The remitted funds were also received by a clustered group of entities,” the I-T department said.

“Form 15CB, read with Rule 37BB of the Income-tax Rules, 1962 (corresponding to Form 146 read with Rule 220 of the Income-tax Rules, 2026), requires the accountant certifying a foreign remittance to verify its taxability with reference to the books of account and other relevant documents. However, the findings raise concerns about whether adequate due diligence was carried out by the accountants before issuing these certificates,” the I-T department said.

BLOOMBERG
New Delhi, August 18

Adani Enterprises Ltd, the flagship of Asia’s richest man Gautam Adani, is back to where it stood just before the conglomerate’s crisis began more than three years ago: the best-performing stock on India’s equity benchmark.

The shares have surged 34% so far in 2026, putting the company on track to end the year as the top gainer on the NSE Nifty 50 Index. It last held that spot at the end of 2022, weeks before Hindenburg Research’s short-seller report in January 2023 sparked a selloff that wiped more than \$150 billion off the power-to-ports group’s market value at one point.

The rally has come alongside share purchases from investors including The Capital Group, Goldman Sachs Group Inc., and SBI Funds Management Ltd. as the conglomerate rebuilds investor support after the short-seller attack, bribery allegations against Gautam and Sagar Adani by US authorities & scrutiny from Sebi. Morgan Stanley in June rated Adani Enterprises as overweight, initiating the Wall Street bank’s



THE SHARES HAVE SURGED 34% SO FAR IN 2026, PUTTING THE COMPANY ON TRACK TO END THE YEAR AS TOP GAINER ON THE NSE NIFTY 50 INDEX

coverage on the stock.

The revival is refocusing the spotlight on Adani as a proxy for India’s infrastructure boom. Investors are putting money into the conglomerate’s ports, airports and power businesses, while overseas lender are also showing more willingness to take exposure. AdaniConneX Pvt., the group’s data-center joint venture with EdgeConneX, recently secured a loan of about \$800 million to fund its expansion.

“Adani is essentially playing the India growth story through infrastructure,” said Vinit Bolinjar, head of research at Ventura Securities, who has had a buy rating on the flagship since 2022. “Few businesses can offer the kind of 20- to 30-year visibility that Adani’s infrastructure businesses can.”

The comeback got another boost last week. A US District Judge permanently dismissed the securities fraud charges against the Adanis, ending a 2024 case that had hung over the group.

And the index provider MSCI Inc.’s latest review raised the free-float factors for several Adani firms, increasing their weights in its gauges. The changes can spur buying from passive funds that track the indexes.

Prudential gets CCI nod to acquire 75% stake in Bharti Life Insurance

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 18

Fair trade regulator Competition Commission of India (CCI) on Tuesday approved the proposal of Prudential Corporation Holdings Ltd, an arm of UK-based Prudential plc, to acquire a majority stake in Bharti Life Insurance Company Ltd.

Prudential plc had announced in May that it would acquire a majority 75 per cent stake in Bharti Life Insurance for Rs 3,500 crore from Bharti

Life Ventures Private Limited and 360 ONE Asset Management.

The proposed transaction involves an initial cash consideration of Rs 3,500 crore (about USD 389 million).

Following completion, Prudential’s Indian operations will include majority-owned Bharti Life Insurance and Prudential HCL Health Insurance, along with minority stakes in ICICI Prudential Asset Management and ICICI Prudential Life Insurance.

Bharti Life Insurance is an IRDAI-licensed insurer.

Keralam CM flags off two containers from Vizhinjam, launches ‘Mission Samudra’

MPOST BUREAU
Vizhinjam, August 18

Keralam Chief Minister V D Satheesan on Tuesday flagged off two containers from Vizhinjam International Seaport, marking the commencement of export-import (EXIM) operations at the deep-water port.

Satheesan also launched ‘Mission Samudra’, a port-led industrial and logistics development initiative aimed at transforming Kerala into a port-centric economic hub. The programme seeks to integrate two international



seaports, a container station and 18 mini ports, while promoting logistics parks, warehouses, free industrial zones and fish-processing facilities.

The Chief Minister said the start of EXIM operations marked an important milestone, enabling goods to be exported to ports

HE STRESSED THE NEED TO STRENGTHEN ROAD & RAIL CONNECTIVITY TO MAXIMISE THE PORT’S POTENTIAL

worldwide, with imports to follow.

He stressed the need to strengthen road and rail connectivity to maximise the port’s economic potential.

The two containers flagged off carried food products, including idli, sambar and banana frit-

ters. Satheesan said the state also plans to export traditional products such as cashew and coir under the proposed ‘Keralam’ brand.

The government is also exploring a cruise terminal in Kochi, river and backwater cruises, an oceanarium and a maritime museum.

Developed by Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ), at an estimated cost of Rs 8,867 crore under a public-private partnership (PPP) model, Vizhinjam was dedicated to the nation in May 2025.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

Canara Bank’s Sector 17-C branch in Chandigarh was inaugurated after renovation on Tuesday. C S Tomar, GM and Circle Head, Chandigarh Circle, was the Chief Guest.

L&T Finance to add 500 branches this year, targets 100 in East

Also unveils gold loan campaign in Kolkata featuring brand ambassador and Indian cricketer Jasprit Bumrah

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata, August 18

Non-bank lender L&T Finance is planning a major expansion of its branch network across rural and urban India, with plans to add around 500 branches this financial year. As of June 2026, the company has 343 branches. Speaking at a press conference in Kolkata on Tuesday, Raju Dodti, Whole-time Director and Chief Operating Officer, L&T Finance, said the company is focused on expanding its distribution network. At present, its book mix stands at 61 per cent urban and 39 per cent rural.

Bengal is also a key focus area for the lender. As of June 2026, L&T Finance has 21 branches in the state with a book size of Rs 133 crore. The company plans to add at least 20-25 branches in Bengal in 2026 and is targeting 100 branches across Eastern India.

L&T Finance entered the gold loan segment last year through the acquisition of the gold loan business of Chandigarh-based Paul Merchants Finance Private Ltd. The all-cash transaction, valued at Rs 537 crore, gave L&T Finance access to a Rs 1,350-crore loan book, 130 branches and around 700 employees, with most



Raju Dodti, Whole-time Director and Chief Operating Officer at LTF

of the acquired branches located in northern India. At the time of the acquisition, the company had no presence in Bengal in the gold loan segment.

“As L&T Finance con-

CLOSER LOOK

- » L&T Finance entered the gold loan segment last year through the acquisition of the gold loan business of Chandigarh-based Paul Merchants Finance Private Ltd
- » The all-cash transaction, valued at Rs 537 crore, gave L&T Finance access to a Rs 1,350-crore loan book, 130 branches and around 700 employees, with most of the acquired branches located in northern India
- » The company’s secured gold loan portfolio grew 182 per cent year-on-year to Rs 3,829 crore in June quarter (Q1) of FY27, compared with Rs 1,360 crore in June quarter (Q1) of FY26

tinues its transformation into a risk-first, tech-first, AI-native retail financial institution under our 2031 strategy, gold finance serves as one of the key drivers of our growth agenda,” said

Dodti. The company’s secured gold loan portfolio grew 182 per cent year-on-year to Rs 3,829 crore in Q1FY27, compared with Rs 1,360 crore in Q1FY26.

According to CRIF data,

West Bengal currently accounts for 2.2 per cent of India’s gold loan market. The overall gold loan market in India, including banks and NBFCs, stands at Rs 21.7 lakh crore, while the market size in West Bengal is estimated at Rs 47,000 crore.

Dodti was accompanied by Kavita Jagtiani, Chief Marketing Officer, L&T Finance, who introduced three new TV commercials featuring the company’s brand ambassador and Indian cricketer Jasprit Bumrah. The campaign, launched during the India-Sri Lanka Test series, aims to create greater awareness

around gold loan offerings.

According to L&T Finance’s latest Gold Loan Study conducted in Kolkata, 54 per cent of respondents considered gold loans a viable financing option. Among them, 33 per cent viewed gold loans as a means to start new businesses, while another 33 per cent saw them as a way to fund home improvements.

On the RBI’s new gold loan framework, which introduces a tiered loan-to-value ratio, Dodti said the company welcomed the move. “The regulation has combined all existing sectors in one composite

master allocation. So now everyone is on the same page and there is a level playing field,” he said.

He added that the new framework had helped address gaps in the interpretation of earlier regulations. According to Dodti, the gold loan market had witnessed a temporary dip as industry experts took time to calibrate themselves to the regulatory changes.

However, he said the market is now showing signs of recovery and expressed optimism about continued growth, without putting a specific number to the expected pace of expansion.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Pawan Shokeen S/o Vinod R/o** H.No. 182, Village Mangol Pur Kalan, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 11/2026, U/S 308(4) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS North Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pawan Shokeen** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pawan Shokeen** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Pawan Shokeen** the said accused of **FIR No. 11/2026, U/S 308(4) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS North Rohini, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
North-West, Court No.-107, 1st First,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11563/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (R.F.P.) WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND**NIT NO. : WRD/JH/CE/DMPH/RFP/21/2026 National Competitive Bidding**

1.	Name of the Work	Request for Proposal for Conducting Studies and Preparation of Detailed Investigation Reports on Comprehensive Dam Safety Evaluation/ Structural Health Assessment for Dam Rehabilitation/ Preparation of Emergency Action Plan, Operation and Maintenance Manual etc. of Chinda Dam under Chief Engineer, WRD, Ranchi, Water Resources Department, Govt. of Jharkhand Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
2.	Mode of Submission of Bids	
3.	Tender fee (In INR)	Rs.10,000.00 (Ten thousand only) - ---- (Non-refundable)
4.	Bid Security (In INR)	Rs.1,00,000/- (One Lakh only)
5.	Time of completion	150 days from the date of agreement
6.	Date of availability of Bidding Document on Website	20/08/2026; 16:00 HRS
7.	Last Date and time of submission of pre-bid queries	31/08/2026; 11:00 HRS
8.	Date of Pre Bid Meeting	01/09/2026; 11:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
9.	Last Date of Submission of online Bids	10/09/2026; 15:30HRS
10.	Date & time of opening of Technical Bid	11/09/2026; 16:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
11.	Name of address of E-procurement officer	Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002 Email: cedesign-wrd-jhr@nic.in
12.	Helpline no.	9162471847, 09787107524, 09599321224, 09304037930, 09110975717

Note:- Please see details on www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
Chief Engineer
Design, Master Planning & Hydrology,
Water Resources Department,
Government of Jharkhand
PR 387804 (Water Resource) 26-27 (D)

SBI STATE BANK OF INDIA

Home Loan Centre (Erstwhile RACPC) Naraina Branch, C-59
Community Centre, Naraina Industrial Area Phase - 1, New Delhi-110028

PHYSICAL AUCTION NOTICE FOR SALE OF MOVABLE PROPERTY ON 04.09.2026

Physical Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Movable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described movable property hypothecated (charged) to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer State Bank of India, the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is Where is", "As is What is" and "Whatever there is" on **04.09.2026 from 10:00 AM to 16:00Hrs.** for recovery of Rs.8,98,950/- (Rupees Eight Lakh Ninety Eight Thousand Nine Hundred Fifty Only) as on 06.02.2026 plus other applicable charges, thereafter due to the secured creditor from **MRS. KIRAN DEVI, Car Loan A/c. No.61288465689**. The Reserve Price will be **Rs.1,85,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Eighty Five Thousand Only)** ("GST as applicable) and the Earnest Money Deposit will be **Rs.18,500/- (Rupees Eighteen Thousand Five Hundred Only)** Demand Draft in favour of **State Bank of India**.
Date and Time of EMD Deposit on 03.09.2026 before 16:00 Hrs.
The Vehicle are available for inspection during banking hours on 03.09.2026 From 11:00 AM to 16:00 Hrs.

VEHICLE DESCRIPTION

Make & Model : HYUNDAI CRETA 1.6
Registration No. : UP16BB5024
Engine No. : D4FBFM400486
Chassis No. : MALC381ULFM025157
Date of Registration : 24.09.2015
Kilometer Run : 202600 Kms
Fuel : Diesel (Polar White)

VEHICLE AUCTION PLACE:

EAST KIDWAI NAGAR MARKET, SOUTH EXTENSION PART-1 NEW DELHI

For any queries please contact: (DSA Associates) (Resolution Agent)
(Mr. Arun Mishra, Mob: 9795324241)

Date: 18.08.2026
Place: New Delhi

Sd/- Anil Kumar Chaudhary, Chief Manager/Authorized Officer,
State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre, RACPC-2, Noida

Govt. of Jharkhand, Energy Department
Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA)
3rd Floor, S.L.D.C. Building, Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi
-833672., Ph.: 0651-2491161, Fax: 0651-2491165,
E-mail: info@jreda.com; Website: www.jreda.com

e-Procurement Notice

Tender reference no.: 17/JREDA/SHMLS/RC/26-27 Dated: 17.08.2026

1	Name of the work	Rate Contract for Design, Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning including 5 years Comprehensive Maintenance Contract (CMC) of 40W LED based solar High Mast Lightning systems (SHMLS) including Remote Monitoring System (RMS) & Global Positioning System (GPS) with Lithium Ferro Phosphate Battery on Turnkey basis across the state of Jharkhand.
2	Estimated cost of 40W per unit (Rs.)	2,33,300/- exclusive GST
3	Period of Completion	06 (Six) Months
4	Contract Period from the date of ITC	05 (Five) Years
5	Date of publication of NIT on website: http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in	20.08.2026 (Thursday)
6	Date & time of Pre-bid meeting	25.08.2026 (Tuesday) at 2.00 P.M.
7	Last date & time for receipt of online bids	12.09.2026 (Saturday) upto 05:00 PM
8	Submission of Bid fee and EMD through Online Via SBI Payment Gateway of Jharkhand Tenders.	12.09.2026 (Saturday) upto 05:00 PM
9	Technical Bid Opening Date	15.09.2026 (Tuesday) at 3.00 P.M.
10	Name & address of office inviting tender	Director, Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA) 3rd Floor, S.L.D.C. Building, Kusai, Doranda, Ranchi- 833672 (Jharkhand)
11	Contact no. of procurement officer	7903935514
12	Helpline no. of e-procurement	0651-3502645

Any corrigendum/addendum can be seen on website: http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in & www.jreda.com. Further details can be seen on website: http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in & www.jreda.com

Sd/-, Director,
JREDA, Ranchi
PR 387771 Energy(26-27)#D

**New Okhla Industrial Development Authority**

Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B Nagar (U.P)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <http://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

- 11/S.M.(Jal)-11/E.T./2026-27, M/o Sewerage (Rewinding of 75 & 50 HP Submersible non clog motor and Repairing of Sluice & Reflex Valve, Transformer, Cable, Starter and other allied work at S.P.S. Sector-31), Noida. (For Two Years). Cost Rs. 27.04 Lacs
- 32/S.M.(Jal)-II/E.T./2026-27, Internal Water Supply in Sector-145, 146, 147, 148, 149 (Erection of Pumping Plant for TW's in Sector-146), Noida. Cost Rs. 26.50 Lacs
- 04/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27, Strengthening of Sewerage (P/L Sewer & Water line for 5% Abadi Plot No. SG-56 & 60 in Sector-128), Noida. Cost Rs. 12.11 Lacs
- 08/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27, M/o W/s (Cleaning of UGR & Redevelopment of T.W. & Pea Gravel Sector-155 & 158), Noida. (AMC for Two Years). Cost Rs. 21.53 Lacs
- 20/S.M.-Jal-III/ET/2026-27, M/o W/s (Water line Repair & Making Internal Connection for Animal Shelter SPCA Sector-94), Noida. (AMC for Two Year) Cost Rs. 10.28 Lacs
- 22/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27, M/o W/s (Repairing and Making Connection of Water Lines in Panchsheel Balak Inter College in Sector-91), Noida. Cost Rs. 13.77 Lacs
- 24/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27, M/o Sewerage (Raising of Sewer Manhole Cover Frame and Cleaning of Sewer Manhole in Bio Diversity Park Sector-91), Noida. (AMC for Two Years). Cost Rs. 12.74 Lacs
- 25/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27, Strengthening of W/s (C/o Starter Room, Chlorine Plant Room and other miscellaneous work in UGR Sector-155 and UGR-158), NOIDA. Cost Rs. 29.80 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date:- 01.09.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 02.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B)

- 08/S.M.-JAL-/E.T./2026-27, M/o W/s (Two Year Annual Maintenance of Water Supply with Some Allied Electrical Work at Gaushala in Sector-135), Noida. Cost Rs. 18.75 Lacs
- 10/S.M.-JAL-/E.T./2026-27, M/o Sewerage (Cleaning & Desilting of Deep Sewer line by Super Sucker Machine in Sewerage Network Sector-130, 132 & 135), Noida. Cost Rs. 25.15 Lacs
- 41/SM-JAL-/ET/2026-27, M/o Sewerage (Two Year Cleaning of Internal sewer line by Portable Re-Cycle Jetting Machine in Village-Nagla Nagli, Nagli Sakhpur Rohillapur & Sector-130 & 132) Noida (Total 03 Villages Cleaning work for Two years) Noida. Cost Rs. 27.24 Lacs
- 42/S.M.-JAL-/E.T./2026-27, Equipment and Machinery (Two Years Annual Repairing of Tractor, Trolley and Water Tanker in Jal Division-I), Noida. Cost Rs. 27.25 Lacs
- 67/SM-JAL-/ET/2024-25, M/o Sewerage (Two Years Annual Running Operation of Sewerage Pumping Station in Sector-115 & 122) Noida. Cost Rs. 26.42 Lacs.
- 29/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2025-26, M/o W/s (Two Years Annual Cleaning & Repairing of UGR in Network-76 & 77), Noida. Cost Rs. 23.06 Lacs
- 38/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2025-26, Strengthening of Sewerage (P/Making Sewer Connection with Sewer Line from Pocket-T & 12 Sector-82 to Across Road Deep Sewer Line Super MIG Sector-93), Noida. Cost Rs. 23.07 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date:- 25.08.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 27.08.2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office: General Manager (Jal)
Sector-5 NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

उद्यान निदेशालय, झारखण्ड, राँची

कृषि भवन, कॉक रोड, राँची- 834008

(कृषि पशुपालन एवं सहकारिता विभाग)

Email ID- ddhbranchi@rediffmail.com

CORRIGENDUM

E-Tender No. Horti/02/2026-27 (PR 385991(Agriculture)26-27 D) for "Supply & Installation of Processing unit/ components under Processing-cum-Value addition in Horticulture-cum-non timber forest produce Scheme of Directorate of Horticulture, Jharkhand For a period of one year"

1. प्रकाशित E-Tender के कंडिका 3.2 Technical Eligibility-IV में उल्लेखित "The bidder should furnish self-attested copy of GST certificate & GST return of last three consecutive Financial Year 2023-24, 2024-25 and 2025-26." के स्थान पर
"The bidder should furnish self-attested copy of GST certificate & GST return of last three consecutive Financial Year 2022-23, 2023-24 and 2024-25" को प्रतिस्थापित किया जाता है।
2. प्रकाशित E-Tender के 3.2 Technical Eligibility-V में उल्लेखित "The bidder should furnish self-attested copy of IT return of last three consecutive Financial Year 2023-24, 2024-2025 and 2025-26 (not the assessment year)." के स्थान पर
"The bidder should furnish self-attested copy of IT return of last three consecutive Financial Year 2022-23, 2023-2024 and 2024-25 (not the assessment year)." को प्रतिस्थापित किया जाता है।
3. प्रकाशित E-Tender के कंडिका 3.2 Technical Eligibility-VII में उल्लेखित "The bidder must submit proof of average annual turnover of not less than 6.75 crore of submitted BID for last three consecutive Financial year 2022-23, 2023-24 and 2024-25 along with details of the audited balance sheet for the three years certified by CA for each year along with UDIN number which was generated during the document certification." के स्थान पर
"The bidder must submit proof of average annual turnover of not less than 6.75 crore of submitted BID for last three consecutive Financial year 2022-23, 2023-24 and 2024-25 along with details of the audited balance sheet for the three years certified by CA for each year along with UDIN number which was generated during the document certification." को प्रतिस्थापित किया जाता है।
4. प्रकाशित E-Tender के कंडिका 3.1-J-II As per Jharkhand Procurement policy 2014 (amendment 2019) vide Memo No. 1342, Dated 16.07.19/ Jharkhand Procurement of Goods and Services Manual, 2024., MSEs firms shall be exempted from EMD. (Provided the firm/organization is registered under the trade related to processing unit/ components only). के स्थान पर
"As per Jharkhand Procurement policy 2014 (amendment 2019) vide Memo No. 1342, Dated 16.07.19/ Jharkhand Procurement of Goods and Services Manual, 2024., MSEs firms shall be exempted from EMD. (Provided the firm/organization is registered under the trade related to Processing unit/ components also)" को प्रतिस्थापित किया जाता है।
5. प्रकाशित E-Tender के कंडिका-3.1-L-As per Jharkhand Procurement policy 2014 (amendment 2019) vide Memo No. 1342, Dated 16.07.19 MSMEs shall be required to deposit only 10% of Security Deposit (SD). The security deposit shall be kept as a security to be pledged in the favor of Director Horticulture Jharkhand. (To get the benefit of MSME, the firm should be registered under the trade related to Processing unit/ components only). No other MSME registration code will be accepted. Security Deposit will return only after getting satisfactory report from concerned districts. के स्थान पर
"As per Jharkhand Procurement policy 2014 (amendment 2019) vide Memo No. 1342, Dated 16.07.19 MSMEs shall be required to deposit only 10% of Security Deposit (SD). The security deposit shall be kept as a security to be pledged in the favor of Director Horticulture Jharkhand. (To get the benefit of MSME, the firm should be registered under the trade related to Processing unit/ components also). No other MSME registration code will be accepted. Security Deposit will return only after getting satisfactory report from concerned districts."

6. प्रकाशित E-Tender के Annexure- II : Checklist of Required Documents For Technical Eligibility क्रम संख्या 5,6,7 एवं 8 में विलिप्त Financial Year 2023-24, 2024-25 and 2025-26 के स्थान पर "Financial Year 2022-23, 2023-24 and 2024-25" को प्रतिस्थापित किया जाता है।
7. प्रकाशित E-Tender के Important Dates एवं Details of the tender के क्रम संख्या 7,8,9,11 एवं 12 में निम्न संशोधन किया जाता है :-

Sl No.	Important Dates एवं Details of the tender	पूर्व निर्धारित तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
7	Document Download Period	29-07-2026 from 10:00 AM to 18-08-2026, 10:00 AM	29-07-2026 from 10:00 AM to 27-08-2026, 10:00 AM
8	Online Bid submission Period	29-07-2026 from 10:00 AM to 18-08-2026, 12:00 PM	29-07-2026 from 10:00 AM to 27-08-2026, 12:00 PM
9	EMD submission Date	18-08-2026, 12:00 PM	27-08-2026, 12:00 PM
11	Date of technical Bid opening	19-08-2026, 01:00 PM	31-08-2026, 01:00 PM
12	Date of Financial Bid opening	22-08-2026, 02:00 PM	03-09-2026, 02:00 PM

8. प्रकाशित E-Tender में Annexure XI – Quantity of Items to be supplied / Installed से संबंधित विवरणी निम्नवत अंतर्स्थापित (insert) की जाती है :-

क्र०	योजना अवयव	संख्या
1	Solar Tunnel Dryer	25
2	Processing and Packaging Shed	24
3	Multipurpose Spice Pulveriser Machine	24
4	Banana Slicer Machine	18
5	Pouch Packaging Machine	24
6	Continuous Band Sealing Machine	24
7	Weighing Scale	30
8	Plastic Crates	2270
9.	प्रकाशित E-Tender की अन्य कंडिकाएँ यथावत समझी जाय।	

ह० / -

PR 387735 Agriculture (26-27)_D

निदेशक उद्यान,
झारखण्ड, राँची

‘Deny early PCs’: Samiullah tells team to shore up defence

Pakistan legend sounds clarion call ahead of clash

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Amstelveen, August 18

Pakistan hockey legend Samiullah Khan has sounded a clarion call to his team, urging them to forge an impenetrable defensive wall and ensure they do not surrender penalty corners in the crucial opening quarter of their high-stakes FIH World Cup pool clash against arch-rivals India on Wednesday.

Pakistan need a win to keep their campaign alive, while India can progress to the next round with a draw.

"I would advise Pakistan captain to keep a compact defence and not concede any penalty corners to India in the first quarter," Samiullah, the current chief selector of Pakistan, told PTI.

"My suggestion to the midfielders is to advance

I WOULD ADVISE PAKISTAN CAPTAIN TO KEEP A COMPACT DEFENCE AND NOT CONCEDE ANY PENALTY CORNERS TO INDIA IN THE FIRST QUARTER

towards the goal instead of passing backwards. The forwards will have to score through diagonal and interchange passes," he said.

The two-time Olympic gold medallist, popularly known as the 'Flying Horse' for his speed on the ground, feels Pakistan's largely young side can handle the pressure.

"They recently played India in the Pro League and gave a tough fight.

Each of these players has played more than 50

matches. They know how important this match is," said one of the key members of the golden generation of Pakistan Hockey.

Samiullah also praised India's transformation since 2016, saying Pakistan needs a similar long-term vision.

"India improved its system, expanded its player pool, improved penalty corners and deep defence, and its players are now earning well. In Pakistan, our federations lack long-term vision and set small goals," he said.

The 74-year-old also lamented the fading intensity of the India-Pakistan rivalry.

"Earlier, India and Pakistan would play Olympic and Asian Games finals and there would be huge hype. In 1978 and 1982, 20,000 to 35,000 spectators would watch us," he said.

When India avenged 1982 Asiad loss vs Pakistan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Amstelveen, August 18

Sixteen years ago, when India and Pakistan last met in a men's Hockey World Cup, the contest was more than just two arch-rivals facing each other.

It was about settling an old score.

The venue was the Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium in Delhi, the same ground where Pakistan had inflicted a painful 7-1 defeat on India in the 1982 Asian Games final.

On February 28, 2010, India returned to the same venue and turned the tables, beating Pakistan 4-1 in the opening match of the World Cup. Later in the same year, they defeated the arch-rival in the Commonwealth Games at the same venue by a 7-4 margin.

For the captain in the 2010 World Cup, Rajpal Singh, the victory was the culmination of a promise he had made days earlier after India had lost to Pakistan in the Champions Challenge in Salta.

"After the defeat, when the team was cooling down, two Pakistani players came up to me and asked, 'What happened? You couldn't play today.' I replied, 'We'll talk to you on February 28, 2010,'" Rajpal told PTI. February 28 was the date of the World Cup opener between the two sides.

But when the big day arrived, the memories of 1982 added enormous pressure.

"Pakistan had defeated us on the same ground in the Asian Games, so the pressure was immense. We had a new coach Jose Brasa. But the team's preparation was good, so we overcame the pressure. That victory healed old wounds," said Rajpal, who played 147 international matches for India.

The victory also gave Shivendra Singh one of his most cherished memories in an India-Pakistan contest.

UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006

Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508

CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 694 Date: 18/08/2026

e-Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M), Vyasi Dam, Juddo Dakpathar, UJVN Ltd. invites online bids from interested party's Brief summary of tenders are given below

NIT No: 09/EE(E&M)/Vyasi Dam/2026-27&10/EE(E&M)/Vyasi Dam/2026-27

Name of work :- 1-Providing servicing for Dam regulation control system & associated equipment and record maintenance of Vyasi Dam, Juddo, Dehradun

Estimated cost: Rs 84,88,907.00 only (GST Extra) & Rs. 13,00,000.00 only (GST Extra)

Date of Availability of bid document: 20.08.2026 from 16:00 hrs on website

Last date for submission of bid document: 09.09.2026 upto 16:00 hrs bids on website

For fuller & further details kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer (E&M), Vyas Dam, Juddo

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jagdish Kumar, S/o: Khem Lal, R/o: B-681, B-Block, Nehru Maidaan, Sonari Post Jamshehpur, Jharkhand** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 59/2021, U/s: 420/468/471/120B IPC, P.S. Connaught Place, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Jagdish Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Jagdish Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jagdish Kumar of P.S. Connaught Place, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Charan Salwan
JMFC-01, Room No. 21, 1st Floor,
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DP/11571/NDD/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY			
E-TENDER NOTICE			
E-Tender No.: 27-TRD-NDLS-2026-27			Dated 18.08.2026
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:			
1	Name of work with its location	Provision of new bracket assembly in place of corroded bracket assemblies of 25 KV AC OHE for ensuring reliability of the OHE System over Delhi Division.	
2	Approx cost of work	Rs. 8,30,59,941.44/-	
3	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 16,61,200/-	
4	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	28.08.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 11.09.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)	
5	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	11.09.2026 (15.00 hrs.)	
6	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in	

PANT, BOWLERS TAKE INDIA CLOSER TO BIG WIN OVER SRI LANKA

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Galle, August 18

Backed by Rishabh Pant's quintessential 66, India's bowlers displayed ruthless efficiency to reduce Sri Lanka to 84 for four at stumps on the fourth day as the visitors positioned themselves for a massive victory in the first Test here on Tuesday.

Pant, Devdutt Padikal (44) and KL Rahul (35) pulled in their combined weight to take India to 193 in their second innings, raising an improbable target of 372 in front of Sri Lanka, who are still 288 runs away from that mark.

For the hosts, skipper Dhananjaya de Silva (31) and first innings century-maker Sonal Dinusha (25) were manning the crease at close.

For a better understanding of the huge mountain in front of Sri Lanka, the highest ever successful chase in Test cricket at the Galle stadium is 344 by Pakistan in 2022, and a 200-plus target was surmounted only twice at this venue since 1998.

The weight of that unfavourable history on them was so evident when the Lankans came out to bat in the fourth innings after a brief rain delay.

They looked cagey, and the first wicket did not take

India leave Lankans Panting



Rishabh Pant became the fastest to 100 sixes in only his 51st game

PTI

too long to come.

Mohammed Siraj hurried Nishan Fernando into a pull, and the latter could not control the shot which was taken in the deep by Prasidh Krishna.

Prasidh himself had a moment of joy soon when he ousted Kamindu Mendis. After setting Mendis up with three in-coming deliveries, Prasidh served one that went away and the left-hander nibbled it to Rahul in the cordon.

Between those two strikes, left-arm spinner Manav Suthar dislodged Pasindu Sooriyabandara, who came in as a concussion substitute for Dinesh Chandimal.

Chandimal sustained an injury while fielding during the first session of the day, hitting his shoulder and head hard on the ground.

Chandimal was cleared of any injury in the subsequent scan, but could not clear the concussion test.

However, that chancy entry into Test cricket lasted just one ball, as Sooriyabandara was trapped leg before by Suthar who later added the wicket of Lahiru Udara to his burgeoning kitty.

Earlier, the Lankan bowlers were suitably rewarded with regular wickets for using the pitch and conditions to good effect. But Padikkal first and Pant later ensured that there would not be

IN SHORT

» Pant became the first Indian player and fourth in the world to complete the rare milestone of 100 sixes in Test cricket

» The highest ever successful chase in Test cricket at the Galle stadium is 344 by Pakistan in 2022, and a 200-plus target was surmounted only twice at this venue since 1998

too many jitters in the Indian camp. Pant twisted, turned, twirled and fell down while executing his shots in typical Pant-style to reach a 53-ball fifty.

The left-hander reached the little landmark with a six off pacer Lahiru Kumara, and he added 54 runs for the sixth wicket with Ravindra Jadeja.

It was also his 100th six in Test cricket, and he became the first Indian and the quickest batter to achieve that feat. If anyone was ever in doubt over Pant's place in the Test side, this knock would give them an evidence of hsi value in red ball format.

One eye on knockouts, one on survival as India take on Pak

Wagener Stadium set for high stakes match, again

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 18

India will look to extend its decade-long unbeaten run against Pakistan and seal a place in the second round of the FIH Men's Hockey World Cup when the arch-rivals clash in a high-stakes Pool D match here on Wednesday.

India, with three points from two matches, needs at least a draw to progress, while Pakistan, with one point, must win to keep their campaign alive. England have already qualified for the next round after winning both their matches.

India opened their campaign with a 3-1 win over Wales but suffered a 2-4 defeat against world No. 3 England after conceding three goals in the second half. Defensive lapses and an ineffective penalty-corner conversion rate will be the areas of concern for India coach Craig Fulton.

Pakistan, meanwhile, drew 3-3 with Wales after losing 1-4 to England and will need a vastly improved performance to overcome their neighbours. Their penalty-corner execution



PAKISTAN'S LAST WIN OVER INDIA CAME IN THE 2016 CHAMPIONS TROPHY

their return to the tournament after eight years, having failed to qualify for the 2014 and 2023 editions.

The rivalry, however, has historically produced matches where form and rankings count for little. With a place in the next round at stake, both teams will also have to keep their emotions under control.

India's most experienced player Manpreet Singh, with 419 caps, said his side would not underestimate Pakistan.

"The match against Pakistan will be good, but we are not underestimating them. They also have good drag-flickers. We must also create opportunities and capitalise on them. We must focus on our natural game," Manpreet said.

and defence have been inconsistent so far.

India have enjoyed the upper hand in recent meetings and defeated Pakistan 7-1 and 4-3 in the European leg of the Pro League earlier this year. Pakistan's last win over India came in the 2016 Champions Trophy.

The gulf in recent performances is also reflected in their recent international record. India have won medals at the last two Olympics, while four-time World Cup champions Pakistan are making

EB drawn in tough Group

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kuala Lumpur, August 18

Indian Super League champions East Bengal were on Tuesday handed a challenging draw in Group D of the AFC Champions League Two with the Kolkata giants set to face Jordanian champions Al Hussein SC, Iraqi

powerhouse Al Shorta SC and Oman's Al Seeb Club.

The group-stage campaign will begin on September 15 and will be played in a home-and-away round-robin format, with each team facing the other three twice. The schedule is yet to be announced.

Sen overcomes first-game jitters to make Rd 2

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 18



Star Indian shuttler Lakshya Sen overcame early jitters to prevail over Collins Valentine Filimon of Austria in three games to progress to the second round of the men's singles event at the BWF World Championships

here on Tuesday.

Sen registered a 16-21 21-8 21-4 win over Filimon in his opener that lasted 45 minutes.

Sen will next play the US' Garret Tan, who defeated Switzerland's Tobias Kuenzi 21-4 21-15.

The unseeded Indian pair of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand

stunned 16th seeds Lauren Lam and Allison Quynh Lee of the United States in straight games to sail into the pre-quarterfinals of the women's doubles event.

Treesa and Gayatri took just 38 minutes to beat their fancied opponents 21-15 21-12 and progress to the next round.

Women rout S Africa 6-1

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 18

India produced a dominant display to hammer South Africa 6-1 in their second Pool D match of the FIH Women's Hockey World Cup here on Tuesday, strengthening their chances of advancing to the next round.

Six different players found the net for India, with three goals coming in a prolific third quarter as the team turned a comfortable contest into a rout.

Sunelita Toppo (11th minute), Navneet Kaur (17th), Sushila Chanu (25th), Deepika (38th), Lalremsiami (44th) and Sakshi Rana (45th) scored for India.

FILM

ZOYA DESCRIBED NATASHA AS A 'CLEAR-HEADED' WOMAN WHO WAS VERY DECISIVE

‘Kalki Koechlin isn’t the villain of ZNMD’

Zoya Akhtar’s ‘Zindagi Na Milegi Dobara’ recently celebrated its 15th anniversary

Zoya Akhtar's film 'Zindagi Na Milegi Dobara' recently celebrated its 15th anniversary. Talking about the film in a recent interview, Zoya finally cleared the air on Kalki Koechlin's character, Natasha, in the film. Natasha was presented as a killjoy of sorts in the film, but in recent years, fans of the film have said that she wasn't a negative character, as she was quite vocal about what she wanted and wasn't wholly wrong when she landed in Spain to check on her fiancé Kabir,

played by Abhay Deol.

Zoya described Natasha as a 'clear-headed' woman who was very decisive, but it was Kabir who wasn't ready to be on the same page as her, which led to their break-up. Zoya also mentioned that no one knows what happened to them after the credits rolled and left the door ajar on the possibility of the reunion.

In a chat with 'The Hollywood Reporter India', Zoya was asked about treating Natasha 'badly': "You can look at it any way you want. I have guys who tell me that your women are always clear about what they want and the men are always confused, which is kind of true." Comparing her to Katrina Kaif's Laila, Zoya said that both these women are very clear

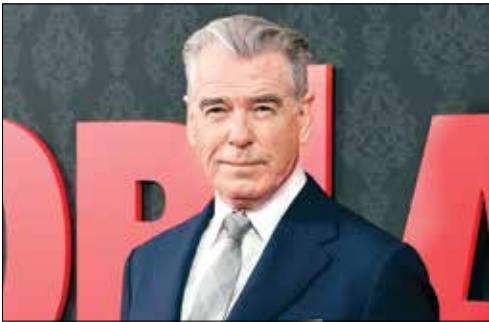
about what they want.

"Natasha wants to get married; she wants to have a life. She doesn't want to work; she wants to do these things, but those things are freaking him out. That doesn't mean it's bad. He is getting freaked out. He doesn't know if he is ready for it and it doesn't pan out," she said and then added, "And no one lands at a bachelor trip. So, I guess that part, they find that weird. I don't. I find her extremely charming and extremely cute."

When asked if she saw Kalki's Natasha as the vamp, Zoya said, "Not at all." She then reminded the audience that Natasha is a part of the group's life, which is why she is present at Laila (Katrina) and Arjun's (Hrithik Roshan) wedding.

AGENCIES

Pierce Brosnan to feature in ‘Extraction 3’



Starring Chris Hemsworth, it also stars Idris Elba

Pierce Brosnan has turned the latest addition to 'Extraction 3' and will feature alongside Chris Hemsworth in Netflix's film. The film is directed by Sam Hargrave and produced by Anthony Russo, Joe Russo and Hemsworth via AGBO and 'Wild State' for 'Netflix'.

It also features Idris Elba and Golshifteh Farahani in pivotal roles, according to the entertainment news outlet 'Deadline'.

Brosnan had his acting debut in the 1979 television film 'Murphy's Stroke'. He got a breakthrough with the role of a con man and detective in the hit television series 'Remington Steele'. The actor is also known for his role in 'The Thomas Crown Affair' and others.

Besides Brosnan, actors Don Lee, Joe Taslim, Chi Lewis-Parry

THE PLOT DETAILS ARE KEPT UNDER WRAPS

and Siena Agudong will also feature in the film, according to 'Deadline'. The plot details are kept under wraps.

The first film was released in 2020 and revolved around Tyler Rake, a fearless black-market mercenary who goes on a deadly mission in Dhaka, Bangladesh, to rescue the kidnapped son of an imprisoned crime lord. Another instalment was released in 2023 and followed Rake getting recruited for a dangerous mission to rescue his ex-wife's sister, Ketevan and her children from a brutal Georgian prison where they are held by her ruthless gangster.

Brosnan will next feature in 'Cliffhanger'. PTI

‘The Revolutionaries’ to premiere on September 11

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 18

Prime Video' announced September 11, 2026, as the worldwide premiere date of its highly anticipated 'Hindi Original' series, 'The Revolutionaries'. Directed and created for a series by acclaimed filmmaker Nikkhil Advani, the high-octane

period drama is produced by Monisha Advani and Madhu Bhojwani under the banner of 'Emmay Entertainment'.

Inspired by true events, 'The Revolutionaries' builds an out-and-out entertaining cinematic experience about the untold story of India's fight for freedom. The series is based on Sanjeev Sanyal's bestseller 'Revolutionaries: The



Other Story Of How India Won Its Freedom'. Written by Sanyuktha Chawla Shaikh, Akshita Wadhwa, Shobhit Narang, and Rutvi Mehta, 'The Revolutionaries' fea-

BHUVAN BAM AND OTHERS HEADLINE THE SERIES IN KEY ROLES

tures a stellar ensemble, with Bhuvan Bam, Rohit Saraf, Pratibha Ranta and Gurfateh Pirzada leading the cast, and Jason Shah, Paoli Dam and Tota Roy Chowdh-

ury in key roles.

Set against the backdrop of India's freedom movement, 'The Revolutionaries' follows four fearless young revolutionaries, Rash Behari Bose (Bam), Sachindra Nath Sanyal (Saraf), Pratibha Lahiri (Ranta) and Bagha Jatin (Pirzada), who dared to stand against the behemoth of the British Empire.